

CLIENTS / PROPERTIES / TRANSACTIONS

Real Estate English

Clarify the relationship. Explain the property. Keep each next step precise.

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For agents, brokers, leasing colleagues, property managers, and transaction coordinators.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Follow eight conversations from the first representation question to property search, negotiation, closing, and ongoing service.

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An inspection finding is not a repair diagnosis | Relay a technical finding accurately, arrange further evaluation, and distinguish a repair request from an agreement.

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Appraisal received does not mean clear to close | Explain separate closing milestones and route unresolved financial or title questions to the responsible professional.

08 Leasing, Property Management, Commercial Basics, Ethics, and Crisis Scenarios 67

The leak is logged, but the tenant needs an update | Acknowledge a missed response, establish current urgency, and give an owned update without inventing a repair appointment.

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Useful detail builds client confidence.

Property decisions combine money, deadlines, technical reports, and strong personal preferences. Clear English helps clients distinguish a listing claim from a verified fact, an offer from an agreement, and a progress update from permission to proceed.

Name whom you represent

Explain the actual professional relationship and its limits before discussing confidential strategy. Do not assume that providing information or arranging access answers the representation question.

"Let us confirm the brokerage role and applicable agreement before discussing your negotiating limit."

Translate preferences into criteria

Ask about the property, budget, travel needs, and other objective requirements. Let the client identify priorities rather than selecting neighborhoods through assumptions about who belongs there.

"Which destination, transport method, and travel time should we use for the search?"

Keep the source beside the fact

Attribute an observation to the inspection report, a measurement to its source, and a financing update to the lender. Coordination does not turn an agent into a technical diagnostician or final approver.

"The report recommends specialist evaluation; it does not supply a repair diagnosis or price."

Report the exact state

Requested, received, reviewed, and cleared are different milestones. A reassuring update names the open item, responsible professional, and next communication without guaranteeing an unfinished result.

"The appraisal is received; the title questions remain open."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

Fictional English practice using mainly US real-estate terminology, not legal, lending, valuation, engineering, or safety advice. Agency, advertising, disclosure, lease, and closing requirements vary. Actual transactions require current documents, local rules, authorized instructions, and appropriately qualified professionals.

Before the buyer shares a negotiating limit

A Read the situation

Clarify representation, confidentiality, and compensation without assuming an agreement already exists.

Prospective buyer Lena asks licensee Ren whether Ren represents both sides of a property transaction. Their relationship has not been established or documented, and the brokerage role for the particular listing still needs confirmation. No fee terms have been agreed. Lena is about to disclose her maximum offer. Ren can explain the questions that must be settled and obtain the applicable documents and broker guidance, but must not promise unrestricted advocacy, a standard commission, or confidentiality beyond the actual relationship and applicable duties.

PEOPLE / Lena: Prospective buyer | Ren: Real-estate licensee

CLARIFY THE ROLE BEFORE INVITING TRUST

A friendly conversation may sound like personal representation to a newcomer. Answer that concern directly and identify what needs confirmation. Do not encourage a negotiating disclosure while the professional role is unresolved, or substitute general reassurance for the actual terms and duties.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which two issues should Ren clarify before discussing Lena's negotiating limit?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Whom the brokerage represents and the duties of that relationship | B The seller's asking price and the property's bedroom count |
| C The appraisal date and the lender's document checklist | D The viewing schedule and the preferred closing day |

2. What is Lena about to share?

- | | |
|--------------------------------|--|
| A A final loan approval | B The seller's authorized reserve price |
| C Her maximum offer | D A confirmed appraisal value |

3. What should Ren verify before describing the available arrangement?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A A standard commission assumed to apply everywhere | B A guarantee that one professional can advocate without limits for both parties |
| C The brokerage's role, local requirements, and applicable documents | D A universal agency rule inferred from the property's price |

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

agency

A legal representation relationship defined by applicable law.

IN USE clarify the agency relationship

principal

The person or entity represented by an agent.

IN USE identify the principal

fiduciary duty

A duty of loyalty or care arising in a relationship under applicable law.

IN USE explain applicable fiduciary duties

buyer representation

Acting for a buyer under an established relationship.

IN USE discuss buyer representation

seller representation

Acting for a seller under an established relationship.

IN USE confirm seller representation

dual agency

Representation of both sides where permitted and subject to applicable conditions.

IN USE review dual-agency restrictions

designated agency

An arrangement assigning different representatives within a brokerage where permitted.

IN USE explain designated agency

non-agency relationship

A permitted service relationship without an agency role.

IN USE clarify a non-agency relationship

transaction broker

A professional facilitating a transaction under a jurisdiction's non-agency framework.

IN USE verify the transaction-broker role

brokerage

The business through which real-estate services are provided.

IN USE identify the brokerage

managing broker

The broker responsible for supervision under the relevant structure.

IN USE consult the managing broker

representation agreement

A document setting out a representation relationship and terms.

IN USE review the representation agreement

Precision check

Providing access or information does not, by itself, explain whom a licensee represents. Ask for the actual relationship and its duties. Labels such as dual agency or transaction broker cannot be assumed available or identical across jurisdictions.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

listing agreement

An agreement for marketing or representing a property's seller.

IN USE examine the listing agreement

exclusivity

A contractual restriction on using other representatives within a stated scope.

IN USE clarify the exclusivity term

agreement term

The period during which an agreement operates.

IN USE confirm the agreement term

service scope

The work included in the professional engagement.

IN USE define the service scope

compensation

Payment for professional services on agreed terms.

IN USE negotiate compensation

commission

A form of compensation often linked to a completed transaction.

IN USE explain the commission basis

fee obligation

A contractual responsibility to pay a specified fee.

IN USE identify the fee obligation

informed consent

Agreement based on relevant information and understanding.

IN USE obtain required informed consent

conflict of interest

A competing interest that may affect professional judgment or duties.

IN USE disclose a conflict of interest

confidential information

Information subject to protection under applicable duties or terms.

IN USE handle confidential information

material fact

A fact important to a transaction or decision in context.

IN USE disclose a material fact

termination provision

Terms governing how an agreement may end.

IN USE review the termination provision

Precision check

Who represents a party and who pays a fee are distinct questions. Compensation terms must be discussed in their actual contractual context. Do not call a fee legally standard, assume another party will pay it, or describe a negotiable term as already accepted.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ADDRESS THE QUESTION

"We should clarify whom the brokerage represents before discussing your strategy."

NAME THE MISSING FACT

"I need to confirm the brokerage's role for this listing."

SEPARATE COMPENSATION

"The representation role and fee obligations are distinct questions."

PRESERVE CHOICE

"We can explain the proposed terms before you decide whether to agree."

PAUSE THE DISCLOSURE

"Please hold your maximum offer until we have clarified the relationship."

USE THE DOCUMENTS

"Let us review the applicable agreement and disclosures."

AVOID A UNIVERSAL CLAIM

"Available arrangements and duties depend on the applicable rules."

CLOSE WITH VERIFICATION

"I will obtain the role information and broker guidance first."

Represents versus assists

Assistance describes an action; representation describes a professional legal relationship.

Before

Use before to sequence clarification ahead of a sensitive disclosure.

May be permitted

This phrase preserves jurisdictional variation rather than promising universal availability.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

EXPLAIN SCOPE

"The agreement should identify the services included."

CLARIFY EXCLUSIVITY

"Let us check what the exclusivity provision actually restricts."

IDENTIFY THE PAYER

"The documents need to explain who owes which payment under what conditions."

INVITE A PRECISE QUESTION

"Which part of the proposed arrangement would you like clarified?"

CHECK THE PERIOD

"What dates and properties does this term cover?"

AVOID A FEE ASSUMPTION

"No compensation terms have been agreed in this conversation."

LIMIT ASSURANCE

"I cannot promise duties beyond the actual relationship and applicable requirements."

CONFIRM UNDERSTANDING

"Does this explanation distinguish representation from payment?"

Agreed versus proposed

A discussed fee is not necessarily an accepted contractual obligation.

Scope and term

Scope concerns what is covered; term concerns the duration.

Who pays

Payment source alone should not be used as a complete description of representation duties.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response best addresses Lena's immediate concern?

- A** A friendly conversation means I represent you exclusively.
- B** Anyone who opens a property represents both parties.
- C** Let us confirm the brokerage role before you share your maximum offer.
- D** Tell me the limit first, and we can define representation later.

2. Which fee statement is accurate?

- A** No fee terms are agreed yet; we need to review the actual proposal.
- B** A legally fixed national commission applies to every transaction.
- C** The seller has already agreed to cover every buyer fee.
- D** Discussing compensation means Lena has accepted it.

3. Which question separates two issues correctly?

- A** Whom do you represent, and what payment obligations would the agreement create?
- B** Does any fee automatically make you everyone's agent?
- C** Can a payment replace every required disclosure?
- D** Is a showing identical to unrestricted buyer advocacy?

4. Which next step fits Ren's role?

- A** Treat the prospective buyer's silence as full consent.
- B** Obtain the applicable documents and managing-broker guidance.
- C** Invent a local rule to avoid delaying the conversation.
- D** Promise that dual agency is always permitted.

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

Before the buyer shares a negotiating limit

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

termination provision / managing broker / fee obligation / informed consent / dual agency / compensation / agency / exclusivity / buyer representation / service scope

- 01 **Lena:** Before I tell you the highest price I could offer, can you explain whether you represent me, the seller, or both sides of this property?
- 02 **Ren:** Let us clarify the ¹ _____ question first. Our relationship is not established, and I need to confirm the brokerage's role for this particular listing before describing the available arrangement.
- 03 **Lena:** I assumed that because you were answering my questions, you would automatically negotiate only for me. I do not want to misunderstand that.
- 04 **Ren:** Answering questions does not settle the ² _____ question. Please hold your negotiating limit until we have explained the role, duties, and relevant documents properly.
- 05 **Lena:** If your office is connected with the seller, would that mean you can simply represent both of us without changing anything?
- 06 **Ren:** We cannot assume that. ³ _____ is treated differently across jurisdictions, and any permitted arrangement has conditions and limits that need to be explained before a decision.
- 07 **Lena:** Can someone in your office confirm the arrangement for this listing? I need to know whom I can speak to before discussing my limit.
- 08 **Ren:** I will consult the ⁴ _____ and obtain the listing-role information. Then we can discuss the actual options instead of implying that an unresolved relationship already exists.
- 09 **Lena:** When we review the paperwork, I also want to know what work is included. Does the agreement cover the whole search or just this property?
- 10 **Ren:** The ⁵ _____ should answer that, along with any limits. We need to read the proposed terms rather than assume every conversation creates the same package of services.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Lena:** And if I wanted to talk to another agent later, would there be a restriction? I have not agreed to anything exclusive today.
- 12 **Ren:** We would review the ⁶ _____ provision, if one is proposed, and its exact reach. Your question should be answered before you decide whether those terms suit you.
- 13 **Lena:** I also hear different things about commissions. Is there one standard amount that the law makes everyone pay, regardless of the services?
- 14 **Ren:** Do not assume a fixed universal amount. ⁷ _____ needs a clear discussion of the proposed terms. We have not agreed a fee, a payment basis, or who would owe it.
- 15 **Lena:** If another party offers to contribute, does that automatically mean I have no obligation under an agreement I might sign?
- 16 **Ren:** Not automatically. The ⁸ _____ needs to be explained using the actual documents and conditions. A possible contribution and your contractual responsibility are not interchangeable statements.
- 17 **Lena:** I would like time to read the terms, including when the agreement ends and what would happen if I wanted to stop working together.
- 18 **Ren:** We should review the ⁹ _____ as well as the duration. I can explain the proposal within my role and direct legal-interpretation questions to qualified counsel when needed.
- 19 **Lena:** Please send the proposed terms and confirm your office's role. I will wait to discuss my maximum offer until those questions are answered.
- 20 **Ren:** Correct. Any required ¹⁰ _____ must follow a clear explanation of the actual arrangement. Today I will obtain the missing information, not promise unrestricted advocacy before the relationship is settled.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. agency | 2. buyer representation | 3. dual agency | 4. managing broker | 5. service scope | 6. exclusivity | 7. compensation | 8. fee obligation | 9. termination provision | 10. informed consent

A fee discussion is not an agreement

F Say it

A prospective seller receives a proposed service package and fee. They ask for a shorter term. The brokerage has not accepted the change, and the proposal is unsigned.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

change / term / agreement / unsigned

Seller: "I am requesting a shorter agreement ¹ _____."

Broker: "That is a proposed ² _____, not an accepted one."

Seller: "The document remains ³ _____."

Broker: "We should confirm the final terms before recording an
⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. term | 2. change | 3. unsigned | 4. agreement

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the cloze key, then read Lena and Ren's exchange. Pause before Lena's maximum-offer question; stress Ren's words that leave the relationship unresolved.
2. Switch roles and reread turns 9-20. Keep service scope, exclusivity, compensation, and termination as separate questions; do not invent agreed terms.
3. Complete the shorter agreement exchange and check its key. Read it with the proposed shorter term still unsigned and unaccepted.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Turning good neighborhood into a usable search

A Read the situation

Replace vague preferences with client-defined property and travel criteria without assuming affordability or belonging.

Buyer Cam asks agent Imani for a "good neighborhood" and a "short commute." Cam identifies a weekday 9 a.m. destination at Central Clinic, public transport, a target journey of no more than 35 minutes door to door, two bedrooms, and a step-free entrance. Cam proposes a \$450,000 asking-price search cap, but lender qualification and the total ownership budget remain unverified. Imani must build a search from these criteria, check property claims, and avoid promising a commute time or deciding which community suits Cam.

PEOPLE / Cam: Buyer | Imani: Buyer's agent

LET THE CLIENT DEFINE FIT

A broad request invites useful questions, not assumptions about the client's background. Ask which features and travel needs matter, then supply objective information consistently. Treat accessibility details as specific property facts to verify rather than replace them with a vague label such as suitable for everyone.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What commute basis did Cam specify?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Driving time at midnight between neighborhood boundaries | B Walking time from the nearest station only |
| C Any transport method with no arrival time | D Public transport, door to door, arriving for 9 a.m. on weekdays |

2. What does \$450,000 represent here?

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|---|
| A A guaranteed accepted offer | B A proposed asking-price search cap |
| C Confirmed lender approval | D A verified total ownership budget |

3. Which property requirements are stated?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Three bedrooms and a guaranteed school place | B A detached house with no ownership charges |
| C A renovated kitchen and a private garage | D Two bedrooms and a step-free entrance |

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

needs analysis

A structured clarification of a client's requirements and priorities.

IN USE conduct a needs analysis

search criterion

A condition used to select possible properties.

IN USE refine the search criteria

must-have

A requirement the client treats as essential.

IN USE identify the must-haves

preference

A desired feature that may be negotiable.

IN USE rank property preferences

trade-off

A compromise between competing priorities.

IN USE explain a trade-off

search radius

The geographic distance used to limit a property search.

IN USE define the search radius

door-to-door journey

Travel including the full route between actual start and destination.

IN USE estimate the door-to-door journey

peak-hour travel

Travel during a period of high demand.

IN USE check peak-hour travel

walkability

The practical ease of reaching relevant destinations on foot.

IN USE assess walkability using specific routes

transport interchange

A point where a traveler changes services or transport modes.

IN USE check the transport interchange

step-free access

Access along a route without steps, subject to exact route details.

IN USE verify step-free access

clear opening width

The unobstructed width available through an opening.

IN USE confirm the clear opening width

Precision check

A short commute needs a destination, arrival time, mode, and journey boundary. A station-to-station estimate omits walking and waiting. A current route estimate is also not a guarantee of future service or an exact daily travel time.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

floor plan

A drawing showing a property's layout.

IN USE review the floor plan

asking-price cap

An upper advertised-price filter for a search.

IN USE set an asking-price cap

purchase budget

The amount available or intended for the purchase on a stated basis.

IN USE clarify the purchase budget

ownership costs

Ongoing costs associated with holding and using a property.

IN USE estimate ownership costs

property tax

A tax assessed on property under applicable rules.

IN USE check the property-tax estimate

association dues

Recurring charges imposed by a relevant owners' association.

IN USE verify association dues

special assessment

An additional charge for a particular association or public purpose.

IN USE ask about special assessments

insurance premium

The price of an insurance policy for a stated period.

IN USE obtain an insurance-premium estimate

utility cost

Expense for services such as electricity, gas, or water.

IN USE compare utility costs

prequalification

A preliminary lender assessment whose scope and verification vary.

IN USE clarify the prequalification basis

preapproval

A lender's conditional preliminary approval subject to its terms.

IN USE review preapproval conditions

shortlist

A selected group of options for closer review.

IN USE build a property shortlist

Precision check

A price filter does not establish financing or total affordability. Recurring taxes, insurance, association charges, utilities, and possible assessments may matter. Keep a listing's access description provisional until the exact entrance route and relevant measurements have been checked.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE ADJECTIVE

"What specific features would make the area work well for you?"

CONFIRM TRANSPORT

"You plan to use public transport rather than drive."

RECORD THE ACCESS NEED

"We will use a step-free entrance as a requirement to verify."

CHECK THE ROUTE

"We should include walking, waiting, and any interchange."

DEFINE THE JOURNEY

"Are we measuring door to door for a weekday 9 a.m. arrival?"

SEPARATE PRIORITIES

"Which requirements are essential, and which are preferences?"

LIMIT THE PRICE CLAIM

"The search cap is not confirmation of financing or total affordability."

CLOSE WITH A SHORTLIST

"I will compare properties against your stated criteria."

Good for whom

Replace an undefined evaluation with the client's objective needs.

No more than

This expression sets a ceiling, not an average or approximate aspiration.

Door to door

Specify both endpoints so the same words produce comparable estimates.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PRESERVE CLIENT CHOICE

"I can supply objective information; you decide which location fits."

CHECK EXTRA COSTS

"We still need the taxes, insurance, and association-charge estimates."

CLARIFY THE SOURCE

"Is that travel time from the transit provider or the listing description?"

USE THE SAME STANDARD

"We will apply the agreed criteria consistently across the search."

VERIFY THE LISTING

"Let us confirm the access route rather than rely on a broad label."

AVOID A GUARANTEE

"The journey estimate may vary with service and time."

MARK AN UNKNOWN

"The lender's qualification decision is not yet verified."

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please correct any requirement I have recorded inaccurately."

Step-free

This describes a route feature and does not automatically establish every accessibility need.

Cap versus approval

A search limit is an instruction about filtering, not a lender's decision.

Could fit

Use this provisionally while relevant property or cost facts remain unchecked.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which question best clarifies neighborhood fit?

- A** Can I treat good as a universal rating?
- B** Which property features and travel needs should guide the search?
- C** Which background should the neighbors have?
- D** Should I select the area based on where people like you usually live?

2. Which journey estimate is comparable with Cam's target?

- A** Door-to-door public transport for the stated weekday arrival time
- B** A station-to-station time with walking excluded
- C** An off-peak drive with no waiting time
- D** A map distance without transport information

3. How should an unverified access claim be described?

- A** A floor plan proves that all entrances are usable.
- B** The listing says step-free entry; we need to verify the actual route.
- C** The property meets every possible access requirement.
- D** Step-free means no measurements are needed.

4. Which budget statement is accurate?

- A** An asking price includes every future ownership charge.
- B** A search cap guarantees the seller will accept that amount.
- C** \$450,000 is a search cap; financing and ownership costs remain open.
- D** \$450,000 is confirmed borrowing capacity.

Answers and explanations: page 87.

Turning good neighborhood into a usable search

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

trade-off / must-haves / asking-price cap / door-to-door journey / step-free access / special assessment / search criteria / ownership costs / peak-hour travel / shortlist

- 01 **Cam:** I want a good neighborhood and a short commute, but I realize that may not tell you which properties to send me.
- 02 **Imani:** Let us turn those words into ¹ _____. What matters most about the property and your daily journey? I can compare objective details without deciding where you should feel you belong.
- 03 **Cam:** I need to reach Central Clinic by nine on weekdays. I will use public transport, and I want no more than thirty-five minutes from home to the clinic.
- 04 **Imani:** We should measure the ² _____, including the walk, waiting, and changes. A station-to-station number could look short while leaving out a substantial part of your morning.
- 05 **Cam:** Some listings say ten minutes from the center without explaining how. That would not tell me whether I could reach the clinic at the right time.
- 06 **Imani:** Correct. We need ³ _____ information for your stated arrival. Even then, a route estimate is not a guarantee that every service will run at exactly the same speed.
- 07 **Cam:** Inside the property, two bedrooms are essential. I also need an entrance without steps, not just a building described as conveniently accessible.
- 08 **Imani:** I will record those as ⁴ _____. We should distinguish them from preferences so a larger kitchen or attractive view does not silently replace something you said is necessary.
- 09 **Cam:** For the entrance, I would want to know which route the description refers to. A rear route may be very different from the main entrance.
- 10 **Imani:** We will verify the ⁵ _____ and any relevant measurements. A broad listing label is not enough to establish that the actual route meets your needs.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Cam:** I suggest looking at homes advertised up to four hundred fifty thousand dollars. I have not yet completed the lender's checks.
- 12 **Imani:** Then that is an ⁶ _____, not confirmed borrowing capacity. We can use it for the initial search while keeping the financing question visibly unresolved.
- 13 **Cam:** I also do not want to discover later that a property has large recurring charges. The advertised price would not tell the whole story.
- 14 **Imani:** We should collect the relevant ⁷ _____, including taxes, insurance, and any association charges. Missing amounts should stay marked as unknown rather than be treated as zero.
- 15 **Cam:** If a condominium has regular dues, could there also be a separate charge for a particular building project? I would want that checked.
- 16 **Imani:** Yes, ask about a ⁸ _____ where applicable and review the actual documents. I should not infer the absence of extra obligations just because a listing shows the routine monthly charge.
- 17 **Cam:** I might accept less space for a shorter journey. Can the comparison show both, rather than rank a larger home as automatically better?
- 18 **Imani:** We can present each ⁹ _____ against your requirements. If an option misses a must-have, I will say so rather than call it a perfect match.
- 19 **Cam:** Use those criteria for the first search. Please flag any unverified entrance or travel claim, and I will follow up with the lender about the budget.
- 20 **Imani:** Exactly. The ¹⁰ _____ will show the source and status of each relevant detail. You can then compare the options on the criteria you actually chose.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. search criteria | 2. door-to-door journey | 3. peak-hour travel | 4. must-haves | 5. step-free access | 6. asking-price cap | 7. ownership costs | 8. special assessment | 9. trade-off | 10. shortlist

The walking time left out the stairs

F Say it

A listing says five minutes to a station, measured from the building entrance. The apartment is upstairs with no lift. The buyer requires a step-free route from the apartment to the platform.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

entrance / match / criteria / route

Agent: "The quoted time starts at the building ¹ _____."

Buyer: "My requirement covers the complete ² _____."

Agent: "The stairs mean this route is not a step-free ³ _____."

Buyer: "Keep that requirement in the search ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. entrance | 2. route | 3. match | 4. criteria

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. After checking the cloze key, read Cam's requirements aloud: weekday arrival at nine, public transport, thirty-five minutes door to door, two bedrooms, and step-free entry.

2. Switch roles for the budget discussion. Stress asking-price cap and unknown costs; neither speaker may turn \$450,000 into lender approval.

3. Complete and check the apartment-to-platform exchange. Read it again with the stairs treated as a known conflict with the required step-free route.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Three sale prices do not make three equal comparables

A Read the situation

Explain why a pricing comparison needs verified differences rather than a simple unqualified average.

A seller's 1,800-square-foot home is described as in good condition. Three nearby sales closed within 90 days: A, 1,800 square feet in similar stated condition, sold for \$470,000; B, 2,400 square feet, sold for \$540,000; C, 1,800 square feet requiring major repairs, sold for \$430,000. Their simple average is \$480,000. Concessions, measurement sources, and other material differences have not been verified. Seller Rosa wants to call \$480,000 a proven value; agent Dev must explain the comparison's limits.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Seller | Dev: Listing agent

EXPLAIN THE ADJUSTMENT QUESTION WITHOUT INVENTING AN ADJUSTMENT

A seller may understandably favor the highest nearby sale or a neat average. Show the exact differences that affect comparability. Do not replace an unsupported average with invented dollar adjustments merely to sound analytical; distinguish what is known from what the pricing review still needs.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which sale matches the stated size and condition most closely?

A C

B All three equally

C A

D B

2. What is the simple average of the three prices?

A \$500,000

B \$490,000

C \$480,000

D \$470,000

3. What remains unverified?

A Whether B was 600 square feet larger in the supplied figures

B Whether C required major repairs in the supplied description

C Whether the three supplied prices have a computable average

D Concessions, measurement sources, and other material differences

Answers and explanations: page 89.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

comparable sale

A completed sale selected for its relevance to a property's pricing analysis.

IN USE select comparable sales

comparative market analysis

An agent's comparison of relevant market evidence for a pricing discussion.

IN USE prepare a comparative market analysis

subject property

The property being evaluated or discussed.

IN USE describe the subject property

sale price

The reported amount paid in a completed transaction.

IN USE verify the sale price

list price

The advertised asking amount for a property.

IN USE set the list price

price reduction

A decrease in the advertised asking amount.

IN USE document a price reduction

days on market

A listing-duration measure under a stated counting method.

IN USE compare days on market

absorption rate

A sales-to-inventory measure over a specified period and definition.

IN USE define the absorption-rate basis

months of supply

Inventory divided by a defined monthly sales pace.

IN USE calculate months of supply

concession

A negotiated benefit or contribution affecting transaction terms.

IN USE verify seller concessions

adjustment

A supported modification used to account for a relevant difference.

IN USE explain a valuation adjustment

condition

The physical state of a property or component.

IN USE compare property condition

Precision check

An average can be arithmetically correct and analytically weak. Sale B has 600 more square feet; sale C required major repairs. The comparison needs verified characteristics and transaction terms before an unadjusted mean can be treated as useful pricing evidence.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

renovation

Work altering or improving an existing property.

IN USE verify the renovation scope

deferred maintenance

Upkeep that has been postponed and may require attention.

IN USE identify deferred maintenance

living area

Space included under a stated residential measurement definition.

IN USE verify the living-area basis

lot size

The measured area of the parcel of land.

IN USE confirm the lot size

measurement source

The record or method from which a size figure comes.

IN USE identify the measurement source

price per square foot

Price divided by area under a specified measurement basis.

IN USE compare price per square foot

market exposure

The extent and duration of a property's availability to prospective buyers.

IN USE assess market exposure

arm's-length transaction

A transaction between independent parties acting in their own interests.

IN USE verify arm's-length conditions

listing status

The current recorded stage of a property listing.

IN USE confirm the listing status

pending sale

A transaction under contract but not yet completed under the local usage.

IN USE distinguish pending sales from closed sales

valuation date

The date for which a value opinion is expressed.

IN USE state the valuation date

pricing range

A proposed interval for pricing discussion based on specified evidence.

IN USE support the pricing range

Precision check

A listing price is an asking amount, not a completed sale or guaranteed appraisal. Price per square foot also depends on the measurement basis and property differences. Avoid converting a rough comparison into a precise value opinion without the necessary evidence and professional scope.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

VALIDATE THE ARITHMETIC

"The simple average is \$480,000."

NAME THE SIZE DIFFERENCE

"Sale B has 600 more square feet in the supplied figures."

CHOOSE A STARTING POINT

"A is the closest on the stated size and condition, subject to verification."

AVOID INVENTED PRECISION

"I cannot assign a defensible adjustment without supporting evidence."

CHALLENGE THE CONCLUSION

"That average does not by itself prove this property's value."

NAME THE CONDITION DIFFERENCE

"Sale C required major repairs."

REQUEST TRANSACTION DETAIL

"We need to check concessions and other material terms."

CLOSE WITH ANALYSIS

"Let us verify the comparison before setting the pricing recommendation."

Closest on stated facts

This is narrower than claiming a fully verified best comparable.

Unadjusted

The word tells the reader that differences have not yet been accounted for.

Average versus value

One is a calculation; the other is a supported opinion in a defined context.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

KEEP THE SOURCES

"Which record supplied each area measurement?"

CHECK TIMING

"Use the actual closing dates and relevant market conditions."

DESCRIBE CONDITION

"State the renovation or maintenance facts rather than saying perfect."

KEEP THE OUTLIER VISIBLE

"Do not hide the larger property's differences inside the average."

DISTINGUISH PRICES

"Asking price and closed sale price are different measures."

LIMIT THE RANGE

"A pricing range is not a guarantee of an accepted offer."

CHECK AREA BASIS

"Are the square-foot figures measured on a comparable basis?"

SUMMARIZE THE EVIDENCE

"We have three relevant records, but they are not interchangeable properties."

Sold for versus listed at

These phrases identify completed transaction amounts versus asking amounts.

Subject to verification

Name what needs checking so the qualification is useful.

Exact number

Numerical precision does not prove that the underlying comparison is valid.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

03

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which price summary preserves the distinction between arithmetic and valuation?

- A** The comparable range centers on \$480,000 because all three homes are equivalent.
- B** The mean is \$470,000 because A is the closest comparable.
- C** The unadjusted mean is \$480,000; comparability still needs review.
- D** The adjusted mean is \$480,000 after allowing for repairs and size.

2. What should happen before assigning an adjustment for B's extra area?

- A** Multiply by any convenient round number without support.
- B** Assume all square footage has an identical value in every property.
- C** Ignore the extra 600 square feet because the sale is recent.
- D** Verify comparable measurements and supporting market evidence.

3. Which wording distinguishes asking from sold prices?

- A** A pending sale always supplies the final recorded price.
- B** A suggested price is the same as lender approval.
- C** The seller may choose a list price, but the supplied records are closed sale prices.
- D** Every list price is a completed transaction price.

4. Which summary preserves the condition issue?

- A** C's major repairs may affect comparability and require investigation.
- B** C proves that repair needs have no effect on price.
- C** C's condition must be identical to the subject property.
- D** The repair cost is exactly the difference between C and A.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

Three sale prices do not make three equal comparables

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

concession / list price / subject property / pricing range / measurement source / listing status / comparative market analysis / adjustment / price per square foot / comparable sale

- 01 **Rosa:** I added the three sale prices and divided by three: four hundred eighty thousand. Can we use that as my home's value?
- 02 **Dev:** It is a useful starting calculation, not the conclusion of a ¹ _____. We need to compare what actually sold with your house.
- 03 **Rosa:** All three are nearby and closed within ninety days. What makes one more useful than another?
- 04 **Dev:** A is the closer ² _____ on the supplied facts: eighteen hundred square feet, with similar condition. B is six hundred square feet larger.
- 05 **Rosa:** And C sold for forty-three thousand less than A?
- 06 **Dev:** Forty thousand less: four hundred thirty versus four hundred seventy thousand. C needed major repairs; your ³ _____ is described as being in good condition.
- 07 **Rosa:** Then could we add forty thousand to C and say that is what the repairs were worth?
- 08 **Dev:** Not from these records alone. That would be an unsupported ⁴ _____. Other differences may explain part of the price gap.
- 09 **Rosa:** A neighbor said one seller helped with the buyer's closing costs. I do not know which sale.
- 10 **Dev:** Let us verify that ⁵ _____ before relying on the headline prices. We need the transaction terms, not just the amounts on a summary.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Rosa:** The area figures came from separate listings. One description includes a finished basement, but I cannot tell whether its figure does.
- 12 **Dev:** I will check the ⁶ _____ and what each total includes. Otherwise we could compare different categories of space without noticing.
- 13 **Rosa:** Would dividing each price by its area make the comparison fairer?
- 14 **Dev:** ⁷ _____ can help, but it does not correct inconsistent measurements or different conditions. A tidy ratio can still conceal a poor comparison.
- 15 **Rosa:** I still need an asking figure. Buyers will not accept a page of uncertainties instead of a number.
- 16 **Dev:** Agreed. The review should lead to a supported ⁸ _____ recommendation. We can show the unadjusted average without labeling it a proven value.
- 17 **Rosa:** Could your recommendation include a range and explain why A gets more attention? I want to follow the reasoning.
- 18 **Dev:** Yes. A ⁹ _____ lets us explain the evidence and limits. It will not promise what a buyer offers or an appraiser concludes.
- 19 **Rosa:** Keep the three sales, then. Before we choose the asking figure, check the areas, concessions, and other important differences.
- 20 **Dev:** I will also verify each record's ¹⁰ _____. Closed prices, pending transactions, and active asking prices should not be presented as equivalent evidence.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. comparative market analysis | 2. comparable sale | 3. subject property | 4. adjustment | 5. concession | 6. measurement source | 7. price per square foot | 8. list price | 9. pricing range | 10. listing status

A pending price is not a closed sale

F Say it

A property was listed at \$520,000 and is now pending. Its final sale price has not been reported. A presentation labels \$520,000 as the confirmed closed price.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unreported / label / list / pending

Agent: "The \$520,000 figure is the ¹ _____ price."

Seller: "The transaction is currently ² _____."

Agent: "The final sale price remains ³ _____."

Seller: "We need to correct that comparison ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. list | 2. pending | 3. unreported | 4. label

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the answers and read the price discussion in pairs. Say \$470,000, \$540,000, and \$430,000 distinctly; correct forty-three thousand to forty thousand.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress unadjusted mean and measurement source. Keep \$480,000 as arithmetic, not an appraisal or supported adjustment.
3. Complete the pending-sale exchange, check the key, and reread it. Keep the \$520,000 asking price separate from an unreported completed sale price.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Describe the home, not the preferred household

A Read the situation

04

Revise exclusionary listing language and handle showing questions with consistent, property-focused information.

A draft listing describes a home as "perfect for couples without children." The verified property facts are two bedrooms, a fenced patio, and a park 0.4 miles away. No bedroom-size measurements or step-free route details have been confirmed. Listing coordinator Fern and open-house host Malik must replace the household preference with factual copy before review. The viewing team is to provide the same property information and apply the same stated booking process to all visitors, while routing access-related requests for appropriate handling.

PEOPLE / Fern: Listing coordinator | Malik: Open-house host

A WELCOMING DESCRIPTION NEED NOT SELECT THE OCCUPANTS

Promotional wording can communicate an exclusion even when its writer intends warmth. Keep the conversation focused on the property and consistent service. An access question deserves precise information and appropriate handling, not assumptions about someone's medical history or whether they belong in the home.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which draft wording creates the central concern?

A A fenced patio

B A park 0.4 miles away

C Perfect for couples without children

D Two bedrooms

2. Which facts are verified in the case?

A Two bedrooms, a fenced patio, and the park distance

B Step-free access and every doorway width

C A particular household's eligibility to buy

D Guaranteed school admission and room suitability

3. What is the required viewing approach?

A Automatic refusal of any different viewing-format request

B Consistent property information and booking process, with appropriate handling of access requests

C Different availability claims based on perceived household type

D A medical-history interview before answering access questions

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

fair housing

Equal housing opportunity under applicable nondiscrimination requirements.

IN USE follow fair-housing requirements

protected characteristic

A trait covered by an applicable nondiscrimination law.

IN USE avoid decisions based on protected characteristics

familial status

A protected housing category concerning children and related circumstances under US federal law.

IN USE recognize familial-status concerns

steering

Directing housing choices on a prohibited discriminatory basis.

IN USE avoid discriminatory steering

discriminatory preference

Wording or conduct favoring or excluding a protected group.

IN USE remove a discriminatory preference

equal service

Consistent access to relevant assistance under applicable requirements.

IN USE provide equal service

objective feature

A property characteristic that can be described and checked.

IN USE describe objective features

occupancy standard

A rule about permitted occupancy requiring legal and factual context.

IN USE verify an occupancy standard

reasonable accommodation

A disability-related change to a rule, policy, practice, or service where required.

IN USE route a reasonable-accommodation request

reasonable modification

A disability-related physical change to premises where protected or required.

IN USE distinguish a reasonable modification

access request

A request concerning how someone can enter, view, or use a property.

IN USE respond to an access request

showing appointment

An arranged property-viewing time.

IN USE confirm a showing appointment

Precision check

A property description should not become a statement about the preferred buyer's family status. The supplied wording needs correction; replacing it with verified room count, outdoor space, and distance information preserves useful marketing content without choosing the occupants.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

open house

A scheduled period when a property is available for visits.

IN USE host an open house

visitor register

A record of attendees collected under a stated process.

IN USE maintain the visitor register

booking process

The steps used to arrange a visit.

IN USE apply a consistent booking process

availability statement

Information about whether and when a property can be viewed or obtained.

IN USE verify the availability statement

property amenity

A useful feature or facility associated with a property.

IN USE describe property amenities

fenced patio

An outdoor paved area enclosed by fencing.

IN USE verify the fenced patio

advertising copy

Written language used to market a property.

IN USE review advertising copy

photograph caption

Text explaining what a property image shows.

IN USE check the photograph caption

virtual tour

A digital presentation allowing a remote view of a property.

IN USE offer the approved virtual tour

disclosure packet

A collected set of required or relevant property disclosures.

IN USE provide the disclosure packet

showing feedback

Information returned after a property visit.

IN USE record property-focused showing feedback

complaint route

The process for raising and handling a service concern.

IN USE explain the complaint route

Precision check

Consistent service does not mean ignoring an access-related request. Obtain the relevant practical details and route the request under the applicable process. Do not invent a universal occupancy limit, certify an unverified access route, or demand unnecessary medical information as casual conversation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE CONCERN

"This line expresses a household preference rather than a property feature."

KEEP THE REVIEW

"The revised advertisement still needs the appropriate review."

AVOID STEERING

"Let visitors assess the property against their own stated needs."

HANDLE ACCESS PRECISELY

"Which route or viewing arrangement would you like us to check?"

OFFER FACTUAL COPY

"The home has two bedrooms, a fenced patio, and a park 0.4 miles away."

APPLY CONSISTENCY

"Give every visitor the same relevant property information."

VERIFY AVAILABILITY

"Do not change the availability story based on who is asking."

CLOSE WITH OWNERSHIP

"I will send the request to the responsible colleague and track the response."

Property versus occupants

Keep the subject of the advertisement on the home and its verified features.

Perfect for

This phrase may imply a preferred household when followed by personal characteristics.

Same relevant information

Consistency concerns the quality and availability of service, not ignoring individual access needs.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A DIAGNOSIS

"We need the practical access information, not an unnecessary medical history."

CHECK THE IMAGE

"The photograph should not imply a feature we have not verified."

SEPARATE ROOM COUNT

"Two bedrooms does not itself establish a universal occupancy rule."

RECORD USEFUL FEEDBACK

"Note the visitor's property questions without guessing personal suitability."

MARK UNVERIFIED DETAILS

"Bedroom measurements and the step-free route are not yet confirmed."

CORRECT THE COPIES

"Replace the wording in every version using the same approved text."

RESPECT THE QUESTION

"I can confirm the features we know and obtain the missing details."

ESCALATE A CONCERN

"Use the complaint route if someone reports inconsistent treatment."

Not yet confirmed

Use this for measurements or access details that have not been checked.

Which arrangement

A practical question focuses on the request instead of demanding unrelated personal details.

Needs review

Identifying a concern is not the same as giving final legal clearance to revised copy.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which revision best uses the supplied facts?

- A** Guaranteed accessible in every respect.
- B** Two bedrooms, a fenced patio, and a park 0.4 miles away.
- C** Ideal for couples who do not plan to have children.
- D** Suitable only for the household type the seller prefers.

2. Which reply handles an access question appropriately?

- A** Tell me which route or arrangement to check, and I will route the request.
- B** We cannot answer unless you disclose your entire medical history.
- C** The photo proves that every route is step-free.
- D** Everyone must use the same arrangement without review.

3. Which revised listing adds no unsupported feature or household preference?

- A** Two bedrooms, a fenced patio, and a park 0.4 miles away.
- B** Two spacious bedrooms, a fenced patio, and verified step-free entry.
- C** Two bedrooms ideal for a child-free household, with a park nearby.
- D** Two bedrooms with confirmed wheelchair-clear doorways and a fenced patio.

4. Which conduct violates the supplied service approach?

- A** Recording a property-specific question for follow-up
- B** Claiming different availability because of a visitor's perceived household type
- C** Giving visitors the same verified feature sheet
- D** Checking an unverified route

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

Describe the home, not the preferred household

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

complaint route / advertising copy / steering / booking process / disclosure packet / reasonable accommodation / objective feature / discriminatory preference / access request / showing feedback

- 01 **Fern:** The draft says perfect for couples without children. I think we should revise it before sending the listing for review or printing the open-house sheet.
- 02 **Malik:** Agreed. It expresses a ¹ _____ rather than a feature of the home. We can make the description attractive without suggesting which households the seller wants.
- 03 **Fern:** The verified facts are two bedrooms, a fenced patio, and a park four tenths of a mile away. Those give us useful material.
- 04 **Malik:** Let us lead with each ² _____. We should not replace the old wording with another personal label that communicates the same exclusion in a different way.
- 05 **Fern:** The seller says that phrase was meant as a compliment to the home. How would you explain why we still need to change it?
- 06 **Malik:** Focus on the effect of the ³ _____. Readers could understand a preference about who should live there. A factual revision keeps the property appealing while removing that message.
- 07 **Fern:** What about visitors who ask whether the home would suit their family? I can describe the rooms, but I should not make that decision for them.
- 08 **Malik:** Exactly. Avoid ⁴ _____. Give the relevant facts and let the visitor assess their own needs, rather than guide them according to assumptions about personal background.
- 09 **Fern:** We have the room count but not the bedroom dimensions. I would rather be clear about that than promise that everyone's furniture will fit.
- 10 **Malik:** Put the missing measurements in the ⁵ _____ or accompanying status notes for follow-up. The same information should be available to each visitor, not selectively changed from conversation to conversation.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Fern:** A visitor may also ask about a step-free route. We have not checked it, and a photograph does not show the complete entrance sequence.
- 12 **Malik:** Treat that as an ⁶ _____. Ask what practical arrangement or feature needs checking and route it properly, without turning a property question into an unnecessary medical-history interview.
- 13 **Fern:** Does consistent treatment mean offering exactly the same viewing arrangement even when someone asks for a disability-related change?
- 14 **Malik:** No. A ⁷ _____ request needs appropriate handling under the relevant process. Consistency is not a reason to ignore it or decide casually that no adjustment can be made.
- 15 **Fern:** I will give the team the current property sheet and a contact for unresolved access questions. We should also confirm how appointments are recorded.
- 16 **Malik:** Use the same stated ⁸ _____ for visitors, while routing relevant requests. Do not tell one household that no appointments exist when the same slots are offered to another.
- 17 **Fern:** At the end of a viewing, useful comments would concern layout, condition, price questions, or missing documents, not whether I think a person belongs there.
- 18 **Malik:** Right. Record ⁹ _____ in those concrete terms. If a visitor raises a concern about treatment, preserve the actual concern instead of dismissing it as a misunderstanding.
- 19 **Fern:** I will change all three versions: website, printed sheet, and host notes. Please check that the team uses the revised copy at the viewing.
- 20 **Malik:** Then send the consistent version through review and keep the ¹⁰ _____ clear for the team. We can market the property effectively while providing factual information and respectful service to everyone.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. discriminatory preference | 2. objective feature | 3. advertising copy | 4. steering | 5. disclosure packet | 6. access request | 7. reasonable accommodation | 8. booking process | 9. showing feedback | 10. complaint route

The photo is not a measurement

F Say it

A prospective visitor asks for the clear doorway width. The listing has a photograph but no measurement. The team can ask the property contact to obtain an accurate measurement.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

verified / contact / measurement / needs

Host: "The doorway width is not yet ¹ _____."

Visitor: "Please obtain the actual ² _____."

Host: "I will ask the property ³ _____ to check it."

Visitor: "Then I can assess it against my access ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. verified | 2. measurement | 3. contact | 4. needs

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the key and read the listing-review exchange. Contrast the rejected household preference with the three verified property facts.
2. Switch roles for the viewing discussion. Keep consistency in information separate from refusing to handle an access-related request.
3. Complete and check the doorway exchange. Read both roles, retaining the distinction between a photograph, an actual measurement, and the visitor's own access needs.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A thirty-day offer with an unconfirmed loan timeline

A Read the situation

05

Discuss offer timing and protections without turning a proposal or lender estimate into a binding assurance.

Buyer Tomas wants to propose a \$420,000 purchase, an \$8,000 earnest-money deposit, and closing in 30 days. The lender has given only a provisional 35-45-day processing estimate, not final approval. No offer has been submitted or accepted. Agent Elise must explain the timing mismatch and review the proposed financing contingency and deposit terms with the appropriate professionals. The buyer has not authorized removing any protection, and no seller concession or extension has been agreed.

PEOPLE / Tomas: Buyer | Elise: Buyer's agent

SEPARATE A STRONGER OFFER FROM AN UNINFORMED PROMISE

A buyer may want to appear decisive in a competitive negotiation. Help them distinguish an attractive term from a term they can reasonably support. Keep the client's authority central and explain the review needed before changing conditions, rather than treating urgency as permission to remove protections.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What timing mismatch is stated?

- A** Two identical confirmed 30-day commitments
- B** A 30-day proposed close versus a provisional 35-45-day lender estimate
- C** A 45-day signed contract versus a 30-day final lender guarantee
- D** A completed closing before the offer was drafted

2. What is the current offer status?

- A** Rejected by the seller
- B** Signed by both parties with an agreed extension
- C** Not submitted or accepted
- D** Accepted with every contingency waived

3. What has Tomas not authorized?

- A** Discussing a proposed price
- B** Asking about the financing timeline
- C** Reviewing the proposed deposit terms
- D** Removing any protection

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

purchase offer

Proposed terms for buying a property.

IN USE prepare a purchase offer

counteroffer

A response proposing different terms instead of accepting the original offer.

IN USE review a counteroffer

acceptance

Agreement to an offer under the applicable legal requirements.

IN USE confirm valid acceptance

offer expiration

The point when an offer ceases to remain open under its terms.

IN USE verify the offer expiration

earnest money

A deposit showing commitment, governed by the contract and applicable rules.

IN USE explain earnest-money terms

deposit holder

The authorized person or entity holding a transaction deposit.

IN USE identify the deposit holder

contingency

A contractual condition affecting obligations or available rights.

IN USE review the contingency

financing contingency

A contract condition addressing financing under specified terms.

IN USE explain the financing contingency

inspection contingency

A contract condition addressing inspection and related rights.

IN USE review the inspection contingency

appraisal contingency

A contract condition addressing appraised value and related rights.

IN USE clarify the appraisal contingency

home-sale contingency

A condition connected to selling another property.

IN USE review the home-sale contingency

contingency deadline

The contractual time limit for a condition or related action.

IN USE track the contingency deadline

Precision check

Proposed closing in 30 days is not the same as a lender confirming that financing can be ready then. An estimate of 35-45 days creates a specific issue to resolve. Avoid describing either the proposed date or the provisional estimate as a guarantee.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

waiver

Giving up a right or condition under applicable requirements.

IN USE explain the proposed waiver

amendment

An agreed change to an existing agreement.

IN USE document an amendment

addendum

Additional document or terms incorporated into an agreement.

IN USE review the addendum

seller credit

A seller contribution toward specified buyer costs under permitted terms.

IN USE request a seller credit

possession date

The date the buyer is entitled to take possession under the agreement.

IN USE confirm the possession date

closing date

The scheduled or agreed date for completing closing steps.

IN USE verify the closing date

extension request

A proposal to move an existing deadline.

IN USE submit an extension request

notice requirement

Rules governing how and when a contractual notice must be given.

IN USE check the notice requirement

default

Failure to meet a contractual obligation as defined by the agreement and law.

IN USE obtain advice about default

remedy

A response or relief available under an agreement or law.

IN USE clarify available remedies

authorized instruction

A direction given by someone with the relevant decision-making authority.

IN USE record the authorized instruction

negotiating position

The terms and priorities a party is prepared to advance.

IN USE clarify the negotiating position

Precision check

A contingency has exact conditions, deadlines, and notice requirements; its name alone does not explain every protection. Deposit recovery is not automatically assured by calling money earnest money. Actual rights need the contract and qualified advice, especially before waiver or amendment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE MISMATCH

"The proposed 30-day close is earlier than the lender's provisional range."

CHECK FEASIBILITY

"Let us ask the lender what supports the current timing estimate."

EXPLAIN THE CONDITION

"We need to read the financing contingency's exact terms."

SEPARATE REQUEST AND AGREEMENT

"Asking for an extension does not mean the seller has agreed."

KEEP STATUS CLEAR

"No offer has been submitted or accepted yet."

PRESERVE AUTHORITY

"I will not remove a protection without your informed instruction and proper review."

AVOID A REFUND PROMISE

"The deposit's treatment depends on the contract and applicable requirements."

CLOSE WITH REVIEW

"Confirm the timing and terms before authorizing the offer."

Propose versus promise

A proposed term is a negotiating position; a promise can create a stronger assurance.

Subject to financing

The phrase is incomplete without the actual contractual condition and required actions.

Requested versus agreed

An extension request does not alter a deadline by itself.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

STATE THE PRICE

"Your proposed purchase price is \$420,000."

CLARIFY THE DEPOSIT

"The proposed earnest-money amount is \$8,000."

CHECK THE NOTICE

"Who must receive the notice, by what method, and by when?"

SEPARATE POSSESSION

"Closing and possession dates should not be assumed identical."

RECORD PRIORITIES

"Which terms are you authorizing us to propose?"

AVOID PRESSURE LANGUAGE

"Urgency does not remove the need to understand the consequences."

REVIEW A COUNTER

"A counteroffer changes the proposed terms and requires a decision."

CONFIRM THE FINAL VERSION

"Use the exact version you have reviewed and authorized."

May be refundable

Any statement about deposit return needs the governing terms and facts.

Authorize versus discuss

Exploring an option is not an instruction to submit it.

By when and how

Contractual notices can depend on both timing and delivery requirements.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which sentence handles the timing accurately?

- A** A 35-45-day estimate proves final approval.
- B** The seller has already accepted a 45-day extension.
- C** We need to resolve the gap between the proposed 30 days and the lender's provisional 35-45 days.
- D** The lender has guaranteed 30 days because that is our preferred offer.

2. Which statement about the deposit is appropriate?

- A** All earnest money is automatically refundable under every circumstance.
- B** An \$8,000 deposit guarantees financing approval.
- C** Calling the deposit refundable overrides every notice requirement.
- D** We need the exact contract terms before explaining when the deposit could be returned.

3. What should Elise do before removing a protection?

- A** Obtain informed client instruction and the necessary review of consequences.
- B** Infer permission from the buyer's wish to be competitive.
- C** Treat an unanswered message as a blanket waiver.
- D** Let the seller's preference replace the buyer's authorization.

4. The buyer has requested more time, but no acceptance is supplied. Which update is accurate?

- A** The deadline is suspended until the seller answers the request.
- B** The lender's later estimate replaces the proposed contractual date.
- C** The extension is requested; agreement to change the deadline is unconfirmed.
- D** The extension is provisionally agreed because the request has been delivered.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

A thirty-day offer with an unconfirmed loan timeline

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

counteroffer / possession date / closing date / financing contingency / waiver / contingency
deadline / deposit holder / authorized instruction / extension request / earnest money

- 01 **Tomas:** I want to offer four hundred twenty thousand dollars, with eight thousand in earnest money and a thirty-day close. That should look decisive.
- 02 **Elise:** We can discuss those terms, but the proposed ¹ _____ conflicts with the lender's current thirty-five-to-forty-five-day estimate. We need to resolve that gap before presenting thirty days as feasible.
- 03 **Tomas:** The lender said the estimate was provisional. I was hoping that a signed contract might make the process move more quickly.
- 04 **Elise:** It may clarify the transaction, but it does not create final approval. The ² _____ and timing need careful review, rather than assuming the lender will meet a date because we request it.
- 05 **Tomas:** I have not asked you to remove financing protection. I just want to understand how the dates and conditions affect the proposal.
- 06 **Elise:** Understood. Discussing a ³ _____ is not an instruction to make one. We should explain the consequences and obtain the appropriate review before you decide about any change.
- 07 **Tomas:** What does the eight-thousand-dollar deposit mean for me if the financing does not work out? I have heard that it is always refundable.
- 08 **Elise:** The ⁴ _____ terms need to answer that in context. I cannot promise an automatic refund without the contract, the facts, and any required actions being considered.
- 09 **Tomas:** Show me the dates and notice steps as well as the protection itself. I do not want to miss a deadline because I only read the heading.
- 10 **Elise:** Exactly. Read each ⁵ _____ together with the required action. The heading alone does not explain how the condition operates or what happens if a step is missed.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

05

- 11 **Tomas:** If the lender later needs more time, could we simply tell the seller that the closing date has moved?
- 12 **Elise:** We could make an ⁶ _____, but that is not an agreed change. We would need to follow the applicable process and confirm whether the other party accepts it.
- 13 **Tomas:** And if the seller sends back a different price or date, I should not assume that means our original proposal has been accepted.
- 14 **Elise:** Correct. A ⁷ _____ needs a fresh review of the actual terms and their legal effect. We should identify the differences clearly so you can make an informed decision.
- 15 **Tomas:** I also want to know who would hold the deposit and what instructions I should rely on if the offer moves forward.
- 16 **Elise:** We should identify the authorized ⁸ _____ and verify instructions through a trusted route. Do not treat unexpected payment details as verified merely because they mention this transaction.
- 17 **Tomas:** The possession date matters as well because I need to arrange a move. I should not book everything just from the proposed closing line.
- 18 **Elise:** Right. The ⁹ _____ must be checked separately in the terms. We should not promise access to the property before the relevant agreement and closing conditions are confirmed.
- 19 **Tomas:** Ask the lender about a realistic date first. Then walk me through the conditions before I authorize the exact offer you will submit.
- 20 **Elise:** I will record your ¹⁰ _____ after that review and confirm the exact version before submission. At present we have a proposal to examine, not an accepted contract or a guaranteed timeline.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. closing date | 2. financing contingency | 3. waiver | 4. earnest money | 5. contingency deadline | 6. extension request | 7. counteroffer | 8. deposit holder | 9. possession date | 10. authorized instruction

A request to extend is still pending

F Say it

An inspection-response deadline in a fictional contract is Friday at 5 p.m. The buyer has asked to move it to Monday. No agreement to the change has been received.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approved / Monday / Friday / agreement

Agent: "The proposed new deadline is ¹ _____."

Buyer: "The existing stated deadline remains ² _____ at 5 p.m."

Agent: "We need confirmation of the required ³ _____."

Buyer: "Do not describe the extension as ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. Monday | 2. Friday | 3. agreement | 4. approved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. After checking the key, read the offer discussion. Contrast a proposed thirty-day close with the lender's provisional thirty-five-to-forty-five-day range.
2. Switch roles for the deposit and notice discussion. Keep \$8,000, the exact contractual conditions, and the need for authorized instructions unchanged.
3. Complete the extension exchange and check its key. Read Friday at five as the existing deadline and Monday as the requested, unconfirmed change.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

An inspection finding is not a repair diagnosis

A Read the situation

Relay a technical finding accurately, arrange further evaluation, and distinguish a repair request from an agreement.

06

A home inspection reports staining on a basement wall and recommends evaluation by a qualified moisture specialist. It does not establish the cause, give a repair design, or estimate a repair cost. The seller's disclosure marks prior water intrusion as unknown. Buyer Nina asks agent Omar whether the wall only needs paint and whether the seller must pay. No specialist appointment or repair agreement is confirmed. The contractual inspection-response requirements need review before any decision or deadline assurance.

PEOPLE / Nina: Buyer | Omar: Buyer's agent

BE USEFUL WITHOUT BORROWING ANOTHER PROFESSION'S CERTAINTY

An agent can locate the relevant report passage, coordinate a referral, and track the contractual steps. That is substantive help. Avoid turning a request for reassurance into a technical diagnosis, a guarantee of safety, or a conclusion about another party's obligations.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the report establish in this case?

A The seller accepted a repair obligation

B Staining was observed and specialist evaluation was recommended

C The wall only needs paint

D A particular pipe caused the issue

2. How does the seller's disclosure describe prior water intrusion?

A Unknown

B Confirmed never to have occurred

C Fully repaired with a transferable guarantee

D Admitted and priced into an agreed credit

3. Which next step is supported?

A Arrange qualified evaluation and review the contractual response requirements

B Promise that paint will solve the issue

C Guarantee the seller will pay every cost

D Treat a referral as a completed repair

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

home inspection

An assessment of a property's condition within a defined professional scope.

IN USE arrange a home inspection

inspection scope

The systems, access, and services covered by an inspection.

IN USE review the inspection scope

visual observation

A condition identified through what can be seen.

IN USE record a visual observation

accessible component

A component available for inspection under the stated access limits.

IN USE identify accessible components

inspection limitation

A condition restricting what could be inspected or concluded.

IN USE document an inspection limitation

deficiency

An observed shortcoming or condition requiring attention in context.

IN USE describe the reported deficiency

further evaluation

Additional assessment by an appropriately qualified professional.

IN USE recommend further evaluation

specialist referral

Direction to someone with relevant expertise for a specific issue.

IN USE coordinate a specialist referral

moisture intrusion

Entry of water or moisture into a building area.

IN USE investigate moisture intrusion

staining

Visible discoloration that may need explanation or evaluation.

IN USE document wall staining

root cause

The underlying source of an identified problem.

IN USE establish the root cause

repair scope

The work specified to address a condition.

IN USE define the repair scope

06

Precision check

Observed staining, suspected cause, and confirmed diagnosis are different levels of information. The supplied report recommends a specialist; it does not say paint is sufficient. A seller's unknown response is also not a representation that water intrusion never occurred.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

repair estimate

An approximate price for specified repair work.

IN USE obtain a repair estimate

contractor quotation

A contractor's priced proposal for a stated scope and conditions.

IN USE review the contractor quotation

permit

Official authorization for work where required.

IN USE verify permit requirements

code compliance

Conformity with applicable building requirements.

IN USE obtain qualified code-compliance review

reinspection

A subsequent inspection to assess specified work or conditions.

IN USE arrange a reinspection

warranty

A defined promise concerning performance, repair, or other coverage.

IN USE review warranty exclusions

seller disclosure

Information about a property supplied by the seller under applicable requirements.

IN USE review the seller disclosure

disclosure supplement

Additional information added to an earlier disclosure.

IN USE request a disclosure supplement

due diligence

The investigation and review undertaken before a transaction decision.

IN USE track due-diligence items

repair request

A proposal asking another party to undertake specified work.

IN USE submit a repair request

repair agreement

Accepted terms governing specified repair work.

IN USE confirm the repair agreement

repair credit

A negotiated financial allowance instead of or toward repair work.

IN USE review the proposed repair credit

Precision check

A referral is not a confirmed appointment, an estimate is not an agreed price for every possible repair, and a repair request is not an accepted obligation. Keep the technical assessment and contractual decision moving together without pretending either is finished.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ATTRIBUTE THE FINDING

"The report records staining and recommends specialist evaluation."

LIMIT THE DIAGNOSIS

"It does not establish the cause or a repair design."

CORRECT THE ASSUMPTION

"We cannot conclude that paint alone will resolve it."

EXPLAIN UNKNOWN

"The seller marked that history as unknown, not confirmed absent."

COORDINATE EXPERTISE

"I can help arrange an appropriately qualified specialist."

KEEP THE COST OPEN

"No repair scope or reliable cost has been established."

SEPARATE THE REQUEST

"Asking the seller to act is not the same as an agreement."

CLOSE WITH TRACKING

"We will track the evaluation and contractual response requirements."

Records versus diagnoses

A report can document a visible condition without identifying its cause.

Unknown versus no

Unknown does not establish the negative fact that something never happened.

Recommended versus arranged

A recommendation does not prove that an appointment has been booked.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK THE SCOPE

"What did the inspection cover, and what was inaccessible?"

AVOID A GUARANTEE

"I cannot certify the condition from this description."

CLARIFY THE QUOTE

"Does this price cover evaluation or the specified repair work?"

REVIEW THE DEADLINE

"Confirm the contract's dates, notice method, and available options."

REQUEST THE WORDING

"Let us read the exact report passage together."

VERIFY THE APPOINTMENT

"A referral has been sent; the visit is not yet confirmed."

CHECK COMPLETION

"We need appropriate evidence that any agreed work was completed."

PRESERVE THE RECORD

"Keep the report, responses, and any agreed changes together."

06

Estimate for what

A price needs a specified service or repair scope.

Must pay

This asserts an obligation and needs contractual or legal support, not an agent's reassurance.

Resolved

Reserve this for an adequately verified outcome, not a sent message or referral.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which handover to the specialist preserves exactly what the report establishes?

- A** Historic water intrusion confirmed; cosmetic repainting provisionally recommended.
- B** Active plumbing leak diagnosed; repair price awaiting a contractor quote.
- C** Seller's prior repair verified; remaining staining needs a warranty review.
- D** Basement staining observed; cause and repair scope not established.

2. How should the unknown disclosure response be interpreted?

- A** It creates an automatic unlimited repair credit.
- B** The relevant history is not established by that answer.
- C** It proves water intrusion never happened.
- D** It confirms all earlier repairs met current code.

3. Which statement about seller payment is appropriate?

- A** We need the actual contract and any negotiated agreement before asserting an obligation.
- B** Every inspection observation automatically requires seller payment.
- C** A specialist referral is proof the seller accepted liability.
- D** A buyer's repair request is already an accepted amendment.

4. Which update correctly distinguishes progress?

- A** The referral is underway; the appointment and repair scope remain unconfirmed.
- B** The repair is completed because the report was received.
- C** The contractor has agreed to every cost because their name was shared.
- D** All response deadlines are extended automatically during evaluation.

Answers and explanations: page 95.

An inspection finding is not a repair diagnosis

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

seller disclosure / visual observation / inspection scope / specialist referral / due diligence / repair credit / reinspection / repair scope / root cause / repair request

- 01 **Nina:** The report shows staining on the basement wall. Can we assume it only needs paint, or does the photograph tell you what caused it?
- 02 **Omar:** The ¹ _____ is staining. The report does not establish the cause, and I should not turn a photograph into a diagnosis or tell you that paint will resolve it.
- 03 **Nina:** The inspector recommends a moisture specialist. I was hoping the general inspection would answer every question before I had to contact anyone else.
- 04 **Omar:** We should review the ² _____ and the exact recommendation. An inspection can identify an issue requiring another professional's assessment without supplying that specialist analysis itself.
- 05 **Nina:** I noticed that the seller marked previous water intrusion as unknown. Is that effectively the same as saying there has never been a problem?
- 06 **Omar:** No. The ³ _____ leaves that history unresolved. We should preserve the word unknown instead of paraphrasing it as a confident no.
- 07 **Nina:** Who should look at this next, and can you help arrange it? I need to know what to do before the response deadline.
- 08 **Omar:** I can help coordinate a ⁴ _____ and track the response. We will ask about the relevant qualifications, availability, and evaluation scope before describing any visit as confirmed.
- 09 **Nina:** Once the specialist looks at it, I want to understand why the staining occurred, not just receive a general suggestion to cover the mark.
- 10 **Omar:** That is a question about the ⁵ _____. The qualified evaluator can explain their findings and limits. I can help organize the information, but I cannot supply that technical conclusion in advance.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Nina:** If work is needed, I would also want the proposal to say exactly what is included. A single unexplained number would not be enough.
- 12 **Omar:** Ask for the ⁶ _____ and its conditions. Evaluation, repair, permits where required, and follow-up checks may be different items rather than one automatic package.
- 13 **Nina:** Could we ask the seller to handle the work? I do not want your answer to imply that they have already accepted responsibility.
- 14 **Omar:** We can discuss a ⁷ _____ after the relevant review. A request is not a repair agreement, and the actual contract and applicable rules determine the available process.
- 15 **Nina:** Timing worries me. If arranging the specialist takes longer than expected, does that automatically extend the inspection-response deadline?
- 16 **Omar:** No. We need to track the ⁸ _____ alongside the contract requirements. Any extension or notice needs the proper process, rather than an assumption that the clock stops during evaluation.
- 17 **Nina:** If the seller eventually agrees to work, how would I know that the agreed scope was actually completed before relying on it?
- 18 **Omar:** The agreement should address suitable completion evidence and any appropriate ⁹ _____. We should not call the matter resolved solely because someone says a contractor has been contacted.
- 19 **Nina:** Please pursue the specialist visit and check the deadline at the same time. I do not want to lose time while we wait for an appointment.
- 20 **Omar:** Exactly. Any proposed ¹⁰ _____ or work agreement will need its own review and acceptance. I will give you a status update that separates each completed step from what remains open.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. visual observation | 2. inspection scope | 3. seller disclosure | 4. specialist referral | 5. root cause | 6. repair scope | 7. repair request | 8. due diligence | 9. reinspection | 10. repair credit

The quotation covers evaluation only

F Say it

A specialist quotes \$250 for an assessment visit. The quotation excludes repairs. The visit is not yet booked, and no repair design or price has been supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

assessment / repairs / scope / confirmation

Buyer: "The \$250 is for the ¹ _____."

Agent: "It excludes ² _____."

Buyer: "The appointment still needs ³ _____."

Agent: "A repair price will need a defined ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. assessment | 2. repairs | 3. confirmation | 4. scope

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the key, then read the inspection discussion. Stress observed staining, unknown history, and specialist evaluation without adding a diagnosis.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Distinguish scope, request, agreement, and completion evidence; preserve the need to check the response deadline.
3. Complete and check the quotation exchange. Read \$250 as assessment only, with repairs excluded and the appointment still unconfirmed.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Appraisal received does not mean clear to close

A Read the situation

Explain separate closing milestones and route unresolved financial or title questions to the responsible professional.

Buyer Aria sees "appraisal received" on the transaction checklist and asks whether everything is ready to close. The title professional is still investigating a recorded prior lien for which a release has not been verified. Final lender approval is not confirmed. A draft settlement calculation shows \$25,000 cash to close, but final figures and payment instructions have not been verified. Transaction coordinator Samir must give an accurate update and assign follow-up without declaring the title clear, guaranteeing funding, or treating the draft as final.

PEOPLE / Aria: Buyer | Samir: Transaction coordinator

07

A USEFUL UPDATE IDENTIFIES BOTH PROGRESS AND THE OPEN ITEM

A client may hear one completed milestone as confirmation that the whole transaction is finished. Acknowledge the progress, then name the separate unresolved work and its owner. Avoid a vague "everything is fine" that can lead the client to rely on unverified dates or payment instructions.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the checklist confirm?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Title has been cleared | B Final lender approval has been issued |
| C Payment instructions have been independently verified | D The appraisal has been received |

2. Who owns the investigation into the recorded prior lien?

- | | |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A The loan underwriter | B The title professional |
| C The lender's appraiser | D The transaction coordinator |

3. What is the status of the \$25,000 figure?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A The full purchase price | B A guarantee of the final mortgage balance |
| C A draft cash-to-close calculation | D A verified final payment instruction |

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

appraisal

A professional opinion of value for a specified purpose and date.

IN USE review the appraisal

appraised value

The value opinion stated in an appraisal.

IN USE distinguish appraised value from purchase price

underwriting

A lender's assessment of risk and loan requirements.

IN USE track underwriting conditions

conditional approval

Approval subject to specified outstanding conditions.

IN USE review conditional approval

clear to close

A lender status indicating closing readiness under its process and conditions.

IN USE confirm clear-to-close status

loan commitment

A lender's stated commitment subject to its documented terms.

IN USE review the loan commitment

rate lock

An agreement to hold specified loan pricing for a defined period and conditions.

IN USE verify the rate-lock terms

loan-to-value ratio

Loan amount divided by the applicable property value basis.

IN USE confirm the loan-to-value basis

debt-to-income ratio

Debt payments divided by qualifying income under a lender's method.

IN USE explain the debt-to-income basis

title search

Examination of records relevant to property ownership and interests.

IN USE complete the title search

lien

A legal claim or charge against property securing an obligation.

IN USE investigate a recorded lien

lien release

A document or action releasing a lien under applicable requirements.

IN USE verify the lien release

Precision check

Received does not mean reviewed, accepted, or cleared. An appraisal concerns value for its purpose; it does not resolve every title issue or loan condition. Title review, lender approval, final calculations, and closing instructions have distinct owners and statuses.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

encumbrance

A right, claim, or restriction affecting property.

IN USE identify an encumbrance

easement

A right to use another's land for a specified purpose.

IN USE review the recorded easement

title commitment

A statement of terms and requirements for issuing title insurance.

IN USE review the title commitment

title exception

A matter excluded from specified title-insurance coverage.

IN USE explain a title exception

owner's title insurance

Coverage protecting the owner's interest subject to policy terms.

IN USE review owner's title-insurance coverage

lender's title insurance

Coverage protecting the lender's interest subject to policy terms.

IN USE distinguish lender's title insurance

escrow

Holding money or documents pending conditions, or a mortgage account for certain ongoing costs.

IN USE clarify which escrow is meant

settlement statement

A document itemizing transaction funds and charges in the applicable closing process.

IN USE reconcile the settlement statement

Closing Disclosure

A US form detailing terms and costs for covered mortgage transactions.

IN USE review the Closing Disclosure

cash to close

The amount due from the buyer at closing under the stated calculation.

IN USE verify cash to close

disbursement

Release or payment of funds to the appropriate recipients.

IN USE confirm authorized disbursement

recording

Entry of a document into the relevant public records.

IN USE confirm recording status

Precision check

Cash to close differs from the purchase price and can reflect deposits, credits, charges, and loan proceeds. A draft figure is not a verified payment instruction. Closing, funding, recording, and possession also need their actual process and agreement rather than an assumed universal sequence.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE PROGRESS

"The appraisal has been received."

ASSIGN THE QUESTION

"The title professional is investigating that record."

LABEL THE NUMBER

"\$25,000 is the current draft cash-to-close figure."

AVOID A BLANKET ASSURANCE

"I cannot yet say that every closing condition is satisfied."

NAME THE OPEN ITEM

"The recorded lien release has not yet been verified."

SEPARATE APPROVALS

"Appraisal receipt does not confirm final lender approval."

PROTECT THE PAYMENT STEP

"Verify final instructions through an established trusted channel."

CLOSE WITH OWNERS

"I will obtain the title and lender updates separately."

Received versus cleared

Receipt is a document milestone, not a conclusion about its effect.

Draft versus final

Keep the status next to the amount so a client does not mistake a working figure for an instruction.

Owner and lender

These labels distinguish the interest protected by different title policies.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CLARIFY THE DOCUMENT

"Which version of the settlement calculation are you reviewing?"

CHECK THE LENDER STATE

"Has the lender issued its actual clear-to-close confirmation?"

DEFINE ESCROW

"Do you mean the transaction holding arrangement or the mortgage cost account?"

KEEP TIMING CONDITIONAL

"The schedule depends on the unresolved conditions and applicable requirements."

ASK ABOUT A DIFFERENCE

"Please explain which charges or credits changed."

SEPARATE INTERESTS

"An owner's policy and a lender's policy protect different interests."

AVOID A TITLE OPINION

"I will relay the title professional's explanation, not declare the lien resolved myself."

CONFIRM COMPLETION

"We need the responsible party's confirmation of each completed step."

Escrow in context

The same word can describe transaction holding or ongoing mortgage-related payments.

Cash to close

This amount is not interchangeable with down payment, purchase price, or total borrowing.

Confirmed by whom

Identify the professional responsible for the particular approval or record.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which closing update is accurate?

- A** The appraisal clears every lien automatically.
- B** The draft cash figure proves the loan is funded.
- C** Everything is complete because one checklist item is marked received.
- D** The appraisal is received, while title and final lender approval remain open.

2. Who should explain the unresolved lien record?

- A** The lender's marketing brochure without checking the record
- B** The title professional handling the investigation
- C** The coordinator by guessing from the appraisal
- D** The buyer's neighbor based on a similar transaction

3. Which statement properly limits the \$25,000 amount?

- A** It proves the buyer's deposit was never paid.
- B** It is a draft calculation; final figures and payment instructions need verification.
- C** It is the final amount solely because it appears in a draft.
- D** It replaces the need for any closing documents.

4. Which question distinguishes escrow uses?

- A** Does escrow always mean the same account with identical rules?
- B** Does any escrow balance prove clear title?
- C** Can an escrow label replace verification of payment instructions?
- D** Are we discussing transaction funds held pending conditions or the mortgage account for ongoing costs?

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

Appraisal received does not mean clear to close

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

lien / disbursement / cash to close / escrow / clear to close / recording / underwriting / settlement statement / appraisal / lien release

07

- 01 **Aria:** The checklist says appraisal received. Does that mean everything is ready to close and I can treat the remaining steps as routine?
- 02 **Samir:** It confirms receipt of the ¹ _____, which is useful progress. It does not confirm that the lender has accepted every condition or that the separate title questions are resolved.
- 03 **Aria:** What is the title question? I do not want to hear simply that paperwork is pending without knowing which issue needs attention.
- 04 **Samir:** The title professional is investigating a recorded ² _____ associated with an earlier obligation. We have not verified the document showing that the relevant claim was released.
- 05 **Aria:** Does the fact that the loan may have been paid off mean we can ignore the entry in the records?
- 06 **Samir:** We need the title professional's explanation and verification of the ³ _____. I should not declare the record resolved from an assumption about what happened to the old loan.
- 07 **Aria:** We sent the lender everything they requested. What confirmation should I look for now, and who will tell me if something is still missing?
- 08 **Samir:** Final approval is not confirmed. The lender needs to report the current ⁴ _____ status and any outstanding conditions. Sending requested records is not the same as receiving the lender's completed approval.
- 09 **Aria:** Would a clear-to-close message settle every part of the transaction, including title, payment figures, recording, and possession?
- 10 **Samir:** ⁵ _____ is a lender status that needs its own terms and context. We should still confirm the other professionals' requirements and the contract's separate steps.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Aria:** The settlement draft shows twenty-five thousand dollars. Is that what I should transfer now, or is it still a working figure?
- 12 **Samir:** It is draft ⁶ _____, not a verified payment instruction. We need final figures and properly verified instructions before treating either the amount or destination as ready for action.
- 13 **Aria:** I would like to see why that figure differs from my down payment. There may be charges, credits, or deposits that I have not connected.
- 14 **Samir:** We can review the ⁷ _____ with the closing professional. They can explain the actual components and any changes rather than have us guess which line creates the difference.
- 15 **Aria:** The documents also mention escrow in more than one place. Is the money held for this transaction the same as the account for taxes and insurance?
- 16 **Samir:** Not necessarily. ⁸ _____ needs context. We should identify which arrangement each document means and ask the responsible professional to explain its purpose and terms.
- 17 **Aria:** Once everything is signed, I should not assume that funds have already been released or that the records office has completed its part.
- 18 **Samir:** Correct. Confirm ⁹ _____ and the other required steps through the closing process. Signatures, funding, recording, and possession should not be collapsed into one unsupported assurance.
- 19 **Aria:** Send me one update with a contact for each open item. At the moment I cannot tell which professional I should ask about which delay.
- 20 **Samir:** I will obtain those confirmations and the relevant ¹⁰ _____ status when applicable. For now, appraisal received is complete; title, final lender approval, and verified closing instructions are not yet confirmed.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. appraisal | 2. lien | 3. lien release | 4. underwriting | 5. clear to close | 6. cash to close | 7. settlement statement | 8. escrow | 9. disbursement | 10. recording

The changed bank details need verification

F Say it

A buyer receives an unexpected email changing the closing-payment account. The closing professional has not confirmed the change. An established contact number from earlier verified documents is available.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unverified / professional / number / transfer

Buyer: "The account change is currently ¹ _____."

Coordinator: "Pause the ² _____ while it is checked."

Buyer: "I will use the previously verified contact ³ _____."

Coordinator: "Obtain confirmation from the responsible closing ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. unverified | 2. transfer | 3. number | 4. professional

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the key and read the closing update. Give appraisal received, lien release unverified, and final lender approval unconfirmed different emphasis.

2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Keep \$25,000 beside draft, and distinguish transaction escrow from the mortgage account for ongoing costs.

3. Complete the changed-bank-details exchange and check the answers. Read the pause and verification steps in order, using the previously verified contact number.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The leak is logged, but the tenant needs an update

A Read the situation

Acknowledge a missed response, establish current urgency, and give an owned update without inventing a repair appointment.

Tenant Leo reported water under the kitchen sink on Monday and again Wednesday morning. Both reports are logged, but no appointment has been confirmed and no update was sent. Property coordinator Asha now owns the follow-up. The contractor has not yet replied. No immediate danger has been reported, but current conditions need checking. Asha can commit to a status update by 2 p.m., not completion of the repair. Entry arrangements and any rent adjustment require the applicable process; neither has been authorized.

PEOPLE / Leo: Tenant | Asha: Property coordinator

08

A REFERENCE NUMBER IS NOT A SUBSTANTIVE RESPONSE

An upset tenant may be asking for ownership and a reliable next contact, not only an apology. Acknowledge the specific missed update, check the present condition, and explain what is confirmed. A promised status update should remain distinct from an unconfirmed attendance time or remedy.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What has actually been completed?

- A** The contractor has confirmed a visit
- C** A rent adjustment has been approved

- B** The repair has been completed
- D** Both reports have been logged

2. What can Asha commit to by 2 p.m.?

- A** An approved rent reduction
- C** A status update

- B** An unconditional entry into the home
- D** A guaranteed completed repair

3. What needs checking now?

- A** An automatic right to ignore entry requirements
- C** Whether the already stated Monday report existed

- B** Current conditions and the appropriate response urgency
- D** A presumed technical diagnosis by Asha

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

lease

An agreement granting use of property on specified terms.

IN USE review the lease terms

lessor

The party granting the lease interest.

IN USE identify the lessor

lessee

The party receiving the lease interest.

IN USE identify the lessee

security deposit

Money held under lease and legal terms for specified obligations.

IN USE account for the security deposit

rent roll

A schedule of tenants, rents, and related lease information.

IN USE update the rent roll

arrears

Amounts due but unpaid after their due date.

IN USE verify rent arrears

work order

A recorded instruction or request for maintenance work.

IN USE open a work order

service request

A tenant's request for assistance or maintenance.

IN USE acknowledge the service request

triage

Initial assessment of urgency and appropriate response.

IN USE triage the maintenance report

active leak

Water escaping or entering at the time described.

IN USE report an active leak

emergency response

Immediate handling of a situation requiring urgent protective action.

IN USE use the emergency-response process

attendance window

A stated period during which a worker is expected to arrive.

IN USE confirm the attendance window

08

Precision check

Logged, assigned, scheduled, attended, and completed describe different maintenance stages. Here the reports are logged and Asha owns follow-up, but the contractor has not confirmed attendance. A 2 p.m. status commitment must not be restated as a 2 p.m. repair promise.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

entry notice

Information about planned access under applicable lease and legal requirements.

IN USE check entry-notice requirements

access arrangement

Agreed or otherwise authorized practical terms for entering the property.

IN USE confirm the access arrangement

vendor

A supplier or contractor providing a service.

IN USE follow up with the vendor

repair authorization

Approval for specified repair work within the relevant authority.

IN USE obtain repair authorization

completion record

Evidence documenting that specified work has been finished.

IN USE verify the completion record

service recovery

Action to address a service failure and restore a reliable process.

IN USE coordinate service recovery

rent adjustment

A change or credit to rent under an authorized agreement or requirement.

IN USE review a requested rent adjustment

renewal option

A contractual right to extend a lease under defined conditions.

IN USE review the renewal option

break clause

A provision allowing a lease to end early under stated conditions.

IN USE check the break clause

permitted use

The activities allowed in the premises under the lease and applicable rules.

IN USE confirm the permitted use

tenant improvement

Work adapting leased premises for the tenant's use.

IN USE define tenant-improvement responsibilities

common-area maintenance

Shared-property maintenance costs allocated under specified lease terms.

IN USE reconcile common-area maintenance charges

08

Precision check

Entry rules, repair duties, rent remedies, and commercial charge allocations depend on the actual lease and applicable law. Do not assume that a maintenance request authorizes every access arrangement or that a complaint automatically determines a rent adjustment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE FAILURE

"You reported this twice and did not receive an update."

CHECK THE PRESENT

"Is water still appearing, and has the situation changed?"

GIVE THE REAL STATUS

"The contractor has not yet confirmed an appointment."

SEPARATE THE PROMISE

"That is a status-update time, not a guaranteed repair completion."

TAKE OWNERSHIP

"I am responsible for the follow-up now."

ASSESS URGENCY

"Please report any immediate danger through the appropriate emergency route."

COMMIT TO COMMUNICATION

"I will update you by 2 p.m. even if the visit time remains unresolved."

CLOSE WITH THE RECORD

"I will record the current facts, owner, and next contact."

08

By 2 p.m.

State what will happen by that time; a communication deadline is not an attendance guarantee.

Still versus again

Still asks whether a condition continues; again asks whether it has recurred.

Assigned versus scheduled

An owner can be assigned even when no visit is booked.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CONFIRM ACCESS

"We need to follow the applicable entry requirements and arrangements."

TRACK THE CONTRACTOR

"I will follow up with the vendor and escalate the unanswered request."

CLARIFY A REMEDY

"A rent adjustment requires the appropriate review; it is not approved yet."

CHECK COMMERCIAL TERMS

"Shared maintenance charges depend on the lease's allocation rules."

AVOID DIAGNOSIS

"I cannot identify the cause from the message alone."

PRESERVE THE HISTORY

"Both earlier reports should remain linked to the work order."

VERIFY COMPLETION

"We will check what work was done before closing the request."

KEEP THE TENANT INFORMED

"A logged ticket should not replace a meaningful response."

08

Reported danger

Record the actual information without declaring safety from an incomplete remote description.

Requested credit

A financial request is not approval of a remedy.

Closed ticket

A closed record should reflect the verified workflow state, not simply the sending of a message.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response combines empathy with accurate ownership?

- A** The contractor will certainly finish by 2 p.m.
- B** Every rent remedy is automatically approved after two reports.
- C** You reported this twice without an update; I own the follow-up and will update you by 2 p.m.
- D** The ticket exists, so the service issue is already resolved.

08

2. Which status pair accurately describes the maintenance case?

- A** Reports assigned; contractor attendance provisionally accepted
- B** Visit confirmed; repair completion awaiting evidence
- C** Repair authorized; entry arrangements already agreed
- D** Reports logged; contractor attendance unconfirmed

3. What should happen before treating the request as completed?

- A** Replace both earlier reports with a new blank record.
- B** Verify the actual work and record the resulting status.
- C** Close it after sending a reference number.
- D** Assume silence proves a repair occurred.

4. Which statement keeps the rent question within scope?

- A** Any leak automatically cancels all rent obligations.
- B** A coordinator can promise any credit without authority.
- C** Commercial and residential leases have identical remedy rules everywhere.
- D** The requested adjustment needs the applicable review and is not approved yet.

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The leak is logged, but the tenant needs an update

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

repair authorization / work order / active leak / service requests / access arrangement / rent adjustment / attendance window / service recovery / completion record / triage

08

- 01 **Leo:** This is my second call about water under the kitchen sink. Monday's report got a reference number. This morning's got another one.
- 02 **Asha:** I can see both ¹ _____. You should have had an update, and I am taking ownership now. Is water still appearing?
- 03 **Leo:** Yes. I have not reported immediate danger, but I do not know what is causing it. Has anyone agreed to come?
- 04 **Asha:** I will record the ² _____ and reassess urgency through our response process. If immediate danger develops, keep clear and use the appropriate emergency route.
- 05 **Leo:** I need an appointment, not another reference number. Can you tell me when the contractor is coming?
- 06 **Asha:** I cannot confirm an ³ _____ yet. The contractor has not replied. I will escalate that unanswered request with the property team now.
- 07 **Leo:** Please do not start the whole process again. Someone needs to know that I reported this two days ago.
- 08 **Asha:** I will link both reports in the ⁴ _____ and preserve the Monday history. The new call will not replace the earlier record.
- 09 **Leo:** When will you call me? Last time I was told someone would be in touch, and nobody was.
- 10 **Asha:** By two this afternoon, even if the appointment is still unresolved. That is part of putting the ⁵ _____ into practice, not a repair-completion promise.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Leo:** I may be at work when someone becomes available. I have not agreed that anybody can let themselves in.
- 12 **Asha:** Understood. We need to confirm the ⁶ _____ and follow the relevant entry requirements. I will explain the proposed visit and notice before assuming access.
- 13 **Leo:** What happens if the contractor finds work that needs the owner's approval? I do not want another unexplained delay.
- 14 **Asha:** I will identify who handles the ⁷ _____ and track the response. The assessment will establish what work is proposed; I cannot approve an unknown scope now.
- 15 **Leo:** And will this ticket disappear once you send another message? That is what this process has felt like so far.
- 16 **Asha:** A message is not a ⁸ _____. We need evidence of the actual work and its status, and I will keep the communication complaint on record.
- 17 **Leo:** I also want to ask about a rent credit. Please tell me where that request goes.
- 18 **Asha:** I will route the ⁹ _____ request for the applicable review. I can confirm it has been raised, but I cannot promise an amount or approval.
- 19 **Leo:** All right. Call by two, tell me whether anyone has accepted the job, and explain the next step if they have not.
- 20 **Asha:** I will. We will also update the ¹⁰ _____ if conditions change. Today you will hear the confirmed status and who is handling each outstanding item.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. service requests | 2. active leak | 3. attendance window | 4. work order | 5. service recovery | 6. access arrangement | 7. repair authorization | 8. completion record | 9. rent adjustment | 10. triage

Base rent does not include every charge

F Say it

A commercial lease proposal states \$2,000 monthly base rent plus the tenant's defined share of common-area maintenance. The maintenance estimate and allocation details have not yet been supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

08

WORD + PHRASE BANK

charge / details / rent / total

Tenant: "The \$2,000 is the monthly base ¹ _____."

Agent: "Common-area maintenance is an additional ² _____."

Tenant: "We still need the allocation ³ _____."

Agent: "Do not present \$2,000 as the complete monthly ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. rent | 2. charge | 3. details | 4. total

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the key, then read the maintenance call. Let Leo sound frustrated while Asha acknowledges both reports and asks about the current water problem.
2. Switch roles for turns 9-20. Stress update by two, not repair by two; keep contractor attendance, entry, and any rent credit unconfirmed.
3. Complete and check the commercial-rent exchange. Read \$2,000 as base rent, with maintenance allocation details still needed before stating a total.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two office rents use different area figures

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Compare commercial lease quotations without mixing area or cost bases.

A small business is comparing two office proposals. Office A quotes 1,000 usable square feet, 1,200 rentable square feet, and \$30 per rentable square foot per year in base rent. Office B quotes \$2,900 monthly base rent but has not supplied comparable area or additional charges. Neither proposal has been accepted.

PEOPLE / Zara: Business tenant | Paul: Commercial leasing broker

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

rent commencement / usable area / rentable area / base rent / tenant improvement allowance / operating expenses

- 01 **Zara:** Office A is thirty dollars a foot. Office B is twenty-nine hundred a month. A looks cheaper, doesn't it?
- 02 **Paul:** We need the same basis first. A charges on ¹ _____, and that rate is annual, not monthly.
- 03 **Zara:** I multiplied thirty by the one thousand square feet shown on the floor plan.
- 04 **Paul:** That is the stated ² _____. The proposal uses twelve hundred for the rent calculation.
- 05 **Zara:** So thirty times twelve hundred gives thirty-six thousand a year, or three thousand a month.
- 06 **Paul:** Correct, for ³ _____. We still need the other charges before comparing the total monthly cost.
- 07 **Zara:** Then B is one hundred less per month on base rent. Why does A have two hundred extra square feet in the calculation?
- 08 **Paul:** The quoted difference reflects an allocation beyond the usable space. We should obtain the measurement basis and explanation, not assume every building calculates it identically.
- 09 **Zara:** Can you confirm whether both proposals include the same services? One says building services; the other lists almost nothing.
- 10 **Paul:** I will request the ⁴ _____ and who pays each item, including how any annual reconciliation works.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Zara:** I also need two meeting rooms. A's plan has only one, so there may be work before we can move in.
- 12 **Paul:** Ask about the permitted work, approvals, schedule, and any ⁵ _____. An allowance is not automatically a promise to cover every alteration.
- 13 **Zara:** Could I subtract the entire allowance from first-year rent when comparing the proposals?
- 14 **Paul:** Show it separately. Its payment conditions and eligible uses may differ from a rent reduction, and you may incur costs before reimbursement.
- 15 **Zara:** B also offers a month before rent starts. I would like the comparison to show that benefit.
- 16 **Paul:** Yes, with the actual ⁶ _____ date and any continuing charges during the concession period.
- 17 **Zara:** It sounds as though we need a schedule, not just one attractive number.
- 18 **Paul:** Exactly: area basis, base rent, additional costs, fit-out contributions, dates, and unresolved terms. I will not mark missing costs as zero.
- 19 **Zara:** Please send that comparison before we authorize an offer. We have not chosen either office yet.
- 20 **Paul:** I will obtain the missing details and arrange the appropriate lease review. Today's arithmetic does not approve the commercial or legal terms.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. rentable area | 2. usable area | 3. base rent | 4. operating expenses | 5. tenant improvement allowance | 6. rent commencement

An annual quotation is read as monthly

F Say it in a new situation

An office quotes \$24 per rentable square foot annually on 900 rentable square feet. Additional charges are not supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

rent / charges / year / cost

09

Tenant: Twenty-four times nine hundred gives \$21,600 per ¹ _____.

Broker: Dividing by twelve gives \$1,800 in monthly base ² _____.

Tenant: That still excludes any additional ³ _____.

Broker: Correct. We cannot describe \$1,800 as the total occupancy
⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. year | 2. rent | 3. charges | 4. cost

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Low monthly dues and an unfinished roof review

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain condominium documents and identify unresolved ownership costs.

A condominium listing shows \$300 monthly association dues. Meeting minutes mention a roof project under discussion. No final contract, funding decision, or assessment notice has been supplied. A buyer asks whether the low dues prove the building is inexpensive to own.

PEOPLE / Mei: Buyer | Luis: Buyer representative

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

10

WORD + PHRASE BANK

special assessment / master policy / association budget / reserves / document-review deadline / delinquency

- 01 **Mei:** The monthly dues are much lower than the other building's. Is that a reliable reason to choose this one?
- 02 **Luis:** It is one part of the comparison. We should review the ¹ _____ and what those dues cover.
- 03 **Mei:** I saw a roof project mentioned in the meeting minutes. Has the association decided how to pay for it?
- 04 **Luis:** Not in the documents we have. The minutes describe a discussion, not a signed project contract or confirmed funding plan.
- 05 **Mei:** Does the association keep money for major repairs, separate from its ordinary bills?
- 06 **Luis:** That is the purpose of ² _____, where maintained. We need the current financial documents rather than infer the amount.
- 07 **Mei:** The agent sent a reserve study from several years ago. Could that answer the question?
- 08 **Luis:** It gives us a starting point. Check its date, assumptions, updates, and the association's actual funding; a study is not a bank statement.
- 09 **Mei:** If there is not enough set aside, would I automatically receive an extra bill as soon as I buy?
- 10 **Luis:** We cannot say that. A ³ _____ is one possible funding mechanism, but no decision is supplied here.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Mei:** I want the uncertainty visible in the comparison. I do not want us to treat a missing notice as proof there will never be a charge.
- 12 **Luis:** Agreed. I will request the current minutes, project status, financial records, and any existing assessment notices through the proper channel.
- 13 **Mei:** What about the money owners already owe the association? Would unpaid dues affect the building's finances?
- 14 **Luis:** The ⁴ _____ information may be relevant. We need the actual report, not assumptions about particular residents.
- 15 **Mei:** And the insurance summary is only one page. I cannot tell what the master policy leaves for me to cover.
- 16 **Luis:** Ask the qualified insurance professional about the ⁵ _____ and the separate coverage you may need.
- 17 **Mei:** Can we get these documents before my review period expires?
- 18 **Luis:** I will track the request and the applicable ⁶ _____. We must address timing through the actual contract and local requirements.
- 19 **Mei:** Please show three hundred as confirmed dues, with roof funding and other costs still unresolved.
- 20 **Luis:** That is how I will present it. We will separate the known recurring charge from costs and decisions still requiring review.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. association budget | 2. reserves | 3. special assessment | 4. delinquency | 5. master policy | 6. document-review deadline

A draft project estimate becomes a supposed bill

F Say it in a new situation

A building committee has obtained a preliminary elevator estimate. It has not selected a contractor or approved an owner assessment.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

assessment / decision / update / dues

10

Buyer: The elevator estimate is not yet an approved ¹ _____.

Representative: Correct. We need the association's actual funding
² _____.

Buyer: Keep the preliminary figure separate from confirmed recurring
³ _____.

Representative: I will also check the date of the next document
⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. assessment | 2. decision | 3. dues | 4. update

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

The final walkthrough reveals a missing appliance

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Report a condition discrepancy and coordinate a response without promising a remedy.

At a final walkthrough, a buyer finds that a refrigerator listed as included in the signed purchase agreement is missing. Moving boxes remain in the garage. Closing is scheduled for tomorrow. No amendment, credit, possession change, or delay has been agreed.

PEOPLE / Iris: Buyer | Daniel: Buyer representative

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

final walkthrough / written amendment / closing credit / discrepancy / possession condition / punch list

11

- 01 **Iris:** The refrigerator is gone. I remember it being included when we agreed the price.
- 02 **Daniel:** Let us check the signed agreement. Yes, it is listed as included. I will record the ¹ _____ with the time and photographs from today's visit.
- 03 **Iris:** Could it simply be in the garage with those boxes? I do not want to accuse the seller before we know.
- 04 **Daniel:** We can ask through the seller's representative. We have confirmed that it is absent from the kitchen, not what happened to it.
- 05 **Iris:** What exactly is the purpose of this walkthrough? Is it another full inspection?
- 06 **Daniel:** This ² _____ is for the agreed condition and items near closing. A technical concern may still require a qualified professional.
- 07 **Iris:** The garage also has moving boxes. I am supposed to get the property cleared, according to the agreement.
- 08 **Daniel:** I will record those too and confirm the required ³ _____ and timing from the actual terms.
- 09 **Iris:** Can we just deduct the price of a new refrigerator from tomorrow's payment?
- 10 **Daniel:** Not unilaterally. We need a documented resolution through the relevant professionals, including any effect on the closing figures and lender requirements.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Iris:** My movers are booked. I need to know quickly whether tomorrow is still realistic.
- 12 **Daniel:** I will contact the seller's representative and closing team now. I can commit to an update this afternoon, not guarantee the result.
- 13 **Iris:** If the seller offers a payment instead of returning it, what would we need?
- 14 **Daniel:** Any proposed ⁴ _____ needs proper review, agreement, and treatment in the closing documents.
- 15 **Iris:** And if they say it will be returned after we sign?
- 16 **Daniel:** Do not rely on an informal assurance. We should obtain professional advice on the proposed ⁵ _____ and how completion would be verified.
- 17 **Iris:** I would prefer the included refrigerator back, but I have not authorized a new arrangement yet.
- 18 **Daniel:** I will convey that preference without representing it as acceptance of any proposal or waiver of a right.
- 19 **Iris:** Please keep the appliance and the boxes as separate open items. One could be resolved while the other remains.
- 20 **Daniel:** I will maintain that ⁶ _____ and confirm the response to each before reporting the walkthrough issues closed.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. discrepancy | 2. final walkthrough | 3. possession condition | 4. closing credit | 5. written amendment | 6. punch list

A verbal promise to remove stored furniture

F Say it in a new situation

Furniture remains in a garage that the agreement requires to be cleared. The seller verbally promises removal after closing. The buyer has not accepted a changed arrangement.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

item / amendment / acceptance / require

Buyer: Record the furniture as an outstanding walkthrough ¹ _____.

Representative: The verbal promise does not establish an agreed ² _____.

Buyer: Ask the closing professionals what documentation the proposed change would ³ _____.

Representative: I will report the response without treating it as your ⁴ _____.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. item | 2. amendment | 3. require | 4. acceptance

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Agency, Representation, Compensation, and Trust

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Which two issues should Ren clarify before discussing Lena's negotiating limit?

A. Whom the brokerage represents and the duties of that relationship

Lena is about to share sensitive negotiating information, so representation and its duties are the immediate issue. The other pairs concern useful transaction details but do not resolve whom Ren represents.

2. What is Lena about to share?

C. Her maximum offer

The sensitive information identified in the briefing is Lena's negotiating limit.

3. What should Ren verify before describing the available arrangement?

C. The brokerage's role, local requirements, and applicable documents

Available relationships and their duties depend on actual brokerage circumstances and applicable rules, not those assumptions.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which response best addresses Lena's immediate concern?

C. Let us confirm the brokerage role before you share your maximum offer.

Clarifying the unresolved relationship first protects the discussion from unsupported assumptions about advocacy and confidentiality.

2. Which fee statement is accurate?

A. No fee terms are agreed yet; we need to review the actual proposal.

The case supplies no agreed fee or payer commitment, so only the proposed terms can be reviewed.

3. Which question separates two issues correctly?

A. Whom do you represent, and what payment obligations would the agreement create?

Representation and compensation are related but distinct questions that require their own facts and terms.

4. Which next step fits Ren's role?

B. Obtain the applicable documents and managing-broker guidance.

The briefing authorizes explanation and verification rather than unsupported legal claims or assumed agreement.

01 Conversation answers

Agency, Representation, Compensation, and Trust

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. agency. Turn 2. Agency identifies the representation relationship and its duties; the current conversation has not yet established it.

2. buyer representation. Turn 4. Buyer representation requires clarity about the actual relationship; providing information alone does not answer whom the professional represents.

3. dual agency. Turn 6. Dual agency concerns both-side representation, with availability and conditions depending on applicable law rather than convenience.

4. managing broker. Turn 8. The managing broker provides relevant supervisory guidance about the brokerage's role and applicable process.

5. service scope. Turn 10. Service scope defines the included work or properties; it must be read from the actual proposed terms.

6. exclusivity. Turn 12. Exclusivity concerns contractual restrictions on using other representatives; none should be assumed accepted in this unresolved discussion.

7. compensation. Turn 14. Compensation is payment for services under agreed terms; the conversation supplies no legally fixed rate or accepted fee.

8. fee obligation. Turn 16. The fee obligation depends on the actual agreement and payment conditions, not an assumed contribution by another party.

9. termination provision. Turn 18. The termination provision addresses ending the agreement; it differs from simply assuming a conversation can cancel all terms.

10. informed consent. Turn 20. Informed consent depends on relevant information and understanding; silence or an introductory discussion should not be treated as complete agreement.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. term

Seller: "I am requesting a shorter agreement term."

The seller's request concerns duration rather than a completed change to the service package.

2. change

Broker: "That is a proposed change, not an accepted one."

The briefing says the brokerage has not accepted the requested alteration.

3. unsigned

Seller: "The document remains unsigned."

The supplied facts state that no signature has been added to the proposal.

4. agreement

Broker: "We should confirm the final terms before recording an agreement."

Discussion and a requested revision do not establish acceptance of the final contractual terms.

02 Briefing and language checks

Client Intake, Needs Analysis, and Property Search

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What commute basis did Cam specify?

D. Public transport, door to door, arriving for 9 a.m. on weekdays

The briefing supplies transport mode, full-journey scope, destination, and weekday arrival time.

2. What does \$450,000 represent here?

B. A proposed asking-price search cap

The amount is a client-defined search filter, while financing qualification and total costs remain unverified.

3. Which property requirements are stated?

D. Two bedrooms and a step-free entrance

The supplied needs are two bedrooms and step-free entry; the other features have not been requested.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which question best clarifies neighborhood fit?

B. Which property features and travel needs should guide the search?

The question seeks the client's practical criteria rather than substituting demographic assumptions or an undefined judgment.

2. Which journey estimate is comparable with Cam's target?

A. Door-to-door public transport for the stated weekday arrival time

The door-to-door public-transport estimate matches the required route, mode, and arrival time. The alternatives omit or change a required condition.

3. How should an unverified access claim be described?

B. The listing says step-free entry; we need to verify the actual route.

Attribution and verification preserve the distinction between a listing statement and a confirmed property feature.

4. Which budget statement is accurate?

C. \$450,000 is a search cap; financing and ownership costs remain open.

The briefing defines a search filter and explicitly leaves financing and total costs unverified.

02 Conversation answers

Client Intake, Needs Analysis, and Property Search

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

1. search criteria. Turn 2. Search criteria specify the client's practical requirements rather than relying on a universal meaning of good neighborhood.

2. door-to-door journey. Turn 4. The full journey includes travel between actual endpoints, not merely the time spent on a train or bus.

3. peak-hour travel. Turn 6. The relevant travel conditions are weekday morning arrival conditions, not an unrelated quiet-period estimate.

4. must-haves. Turn 8. Must-haves are the client's essential requirements; they should not be silently traded away for other attractive features.

5. step-free access. Turn 10. Step-free access must refer to the relevant real route; a general listing label does not establish that route's details.

6. asking-price cap. Turn 12. The asking-price cap filters advertised properties; it is not confirmed financing capacity or a complete affordability assessment.

7. ownership costs. Turn 14. Ownership costs extend beyond the purchase price and may affect the client's practical budget.

8. special assessment. Turn 16. A special assessment can be an additional charge for a particular purpose; regular dues alone may not describe every obligation.

9. trade-off. Turn 18. A trade-off makes competing priorities explicit while leaving the client to decide which compromise, if any, is acceptable.

10. shortlist. Turn 20. The shortlist is a group for closer review, not a guarantee that all property, travel, and financial conditions are already verified.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. entrance

Agent: "The quoted time starts at the building entrance."

The supplied estimate excludes the route from the upstairs apartment to the building entrance.

2. route

Buyer: "My requirement covers the complete route."

The buyer specified the full route from apartment to platform, not just the outdoor segment.

3. match

Agent: "The stairs mean this route is not a step-free match."

The upstairs apartment without a lift conflicts with the stated step-free requirement.

4. criteria

Buyer: "Keep that requirement in the search criteria."

Retaining the requirement prevents an attractive partial travel estimate from replacing the buyer's actual need.

03 Briefing and language checks

Listings, Property Descriptions, Pricing, and Market Data

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which sale matches the stated size and condition most closely?

C. A

A is 1,800 square feet in similar stated condition; B is larger and C required major repairs.

2. What is the simple average of the three prices?

C. \$480,000

The prices total \$1,440,000; dividing by three gives \$480,000 before any comparability analysis.

3. What remains unverified?

D. Concessions, measurement sources, and other material differences

The briefing explicitly leaves concessions, measurement sources, and other differences unchecked.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which price summary preserves the distinction between arithmetic and valuation?

C. The unadjusted mean is \$480,000; comparability still needs review.

Adding \$470,000, \$540,000, and \$430,000 gives \$1,440,000, or \$480,000 divided by three. No adjustments have been established, and selecting A does not change the arithmetic mean.

2. What should happen before assigning an adjustment for B's extra area?

D. Verify comparable measurements and supporting market evidence.

An adjustment needs a defensible basis rather than an arbitrary figure or an assumption of perfect comparability.

3. Which wording distinguishes asking from sold prices?

C. The seller may choose a list price, but the supplied records are closed sale prices.

Asking amounts, pending terms, and completed transactions describe different states and evidence.

4. Which summary preserves the condition issue?

A. C's major repairs may affect comparability and require investigation.

The known condition difference matters, but the case supplies no isolated repair-cost estimate or causal price adjustment.

03 Conversation answers

Listings, Property Descriptions, Pricing, and Market Data

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. comparative market analysis. Turn 2. A comparative market analysis evaluates relevant differences and terms rather than treating the simple mean as a proven value.

2. comparable sale. Turn 4. A comparable sale needs relevant similarity and verified context; being nearby and recent does not make every property equivalent.

3. subject property. Turn 6. The subject property is Rosa's home; the comparison should be made against its verified characteristics.

4. adjustment. Turn 8. An adjustment should account for a difference using evidence; the case supplies no justified dollar amount for area or repairs.

5. concession. Turn 10. A concession can change transaction economics, so the headline sale price may not describe every material term.

6. measurement source. Turn 12. Measurement source identifies the origin and basis of area figures, which must be checked for a meaningful comparison.

7. price per square foot. Turn 14. Price per square foot is a ratio, not a complete valuation method that removes property and measurement differences.

8. list price. Turn 16. The list price is an asking amount chosen for marketing; it is not established by the mean or guaranteed as a sale outcome.

9. pricing range. Turn 18. A pricing range supports a marketing discussion; it is not a guarantee of an appraiser's conclusion or buyer's offer.

10. listing status. Turn 20. Listing status distinguishes completed evidence from active or pending listings, preventing different stages from being mixed without explanation.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. list

Agent: "The \$520,000 figure is the list price."

The supplied number is the advertised amount, not a reported completed-sale amount.

2. pending

Seller: "The transaction is currently pending."

Pending is the stated status, so completion has not been established.

3. unreported

Agent: "The final sale price remains unreported."

The case explicitly says the final sale price has not been reported.

4. label

Seller: "We need to correct that comparison label."

The presentation incorrectly labels an asking price as a confirmed closed-sale price.

04 Briefing and language checks

Showings, Open Houses, Fair Housing, and Advertising

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. Which draft wording creates the central concern?

C. Perfect for couples without children

The household preference describes favored occupants rather than the supplied property features and requires correction.

2. Which facts are verified in the case?

A. Two bedrooms, a fenced patio, and the park distance

Only the room count, patio feature, and park distance are supplied as verified property facts.

3. What is the required viewing approach?

B. Consistent property information and booking process, with appropriate handling of access requests

The briefing requires consistent service and routing access-related requests, not invented restrictions or intrusive assumptions.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which revision best uses the supplied facts?

B. Two bedrooms, a fenced patio, and a park 0.4 miles away.

The bedroom, patio, and distance description uses verified property facts instead of a household preference or an unverified access claim.

2. Which reply handles an access question appropriately?

A. Tell me which route or arrangement to check, and I will route the request.

The reply seeks practical details and appropriate handling without making unsupported assumptions or demanding irrelevant information.

3. Which revised listing adds no unsupported feature or household preference?

A. Two bedrooms, a fenced patio, and a park 0.4 miles away.

Only the bedroom count, patio, and park distance are verified. Spaciousness, doorway clearances, and step-free access need evidence; the child-free description retains the household preference.

4. Which conduct violates the supplied service approach?

B. Claiming different availability because of a visitor's perceived household type

The briefing requires consistent availability information and booking processes rather than demographic assumptions.

04 Conversation answers

Showings, Open Houses, Fair Housing, and Advertising

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. discriminatory preference. Turn 2. The wording favors a household without children rather than describing the property, creating a familial-status concern.

2. objective feature. Turn 4. An objective feature describes something about the property that can be checked, rather than a favored type of occupant.

3. advertising copy. Turn 6. Advertising copy communicates to potential buyers; the message it conveys matters even if the writer describes a different intention.

4. steering. Turn 8. Steering directs housing choices on an improper discriminatory basis; visitors should assess objective facts against their own needs.

5. disclosure packet. Turn 10. The shared property-information packet should preserve what is known and what still needs verification, rather than create unsupported assurances.

6. access request. Turn 12. An access request needs practical route or arrangement information; the case does not establish that the route is already suitable.

7. reasonable accommodation. Turn 14. A reasonable-accommodation request concerns a disability-related change to a rule or service and should receive appropriate handling under applicable requirements.

8. booking process. Turn 16. The booking process should be applied consistently rather than altered because of assumptions about a visitor's household.

9. showing feedback. Turn 18. Showing feedback should capture property-related observations and questions, not invented judgments about a visitor's personal suitability.

10. complaint route. Turn 20. The complaint route gives visitors and staff a defined way to raise concerns about service or treatment.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. verified

Host: "The doorway width is not yet verified."

A photograph does not supply the accurate measurement requested in the case.

2. measurement

Visitor: "Please obtain the actual measurement."

The visitor needs a dimension rather than a general impression from an image.

3. contact

Host: "I will ask the property contact to check it."

The briefing identifies the property contact as the route for obtaining the dimension.

4. needs

Visitor: "Then I can assess it against my access needs."

The verified information lets the visitor evaluate practical fit without the host guessing suitability.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Offers, Counteroffers, Negotiation, and Contingencies

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What timing mismatch is stated?

B. A 30-day proposed close versus a provisional 35-45-day lender estimate

The buyer's proposed date is earlier than the lender's provisional range, and neither establishes final financing approval.

2. What is the current offer status?

C. Not submitted or accepted

The briefing explicitly says no offer has been submitted or accepted.

3. What has Tomas not authorized?

D. Removing any protection

The case permits discussion but contains no instruction to remove protections.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which sentence handles the timing accurately?

C. We need to resolve the gap between the proposed 30 days and the lender's provisional 35-45 days.

The sentence retains both actual timeframes and their status without inventing approval or agreement.

2. Which statement about the deposit is appropriate?

D. We need the exact contract terms before explaining when the deposit could be returned.

The deposit's treatment depends on the agreement, applicable rules, and facts rather than its label or amount alone.

3. What should Elise do before removing a protection?

A. Obtain informed client instruction and the necessary review of consequences.

The case contains no authorization to remove protections; urgency is not a substitute for an informed decision.

4. The buyer has requested more time, but no acceptance is supplied. Which update is accurate?

C. The extension is requested; agreement to change the deadline is unconfirmed.

Delivery of a request proves neither acceptance nor suspension of a deadline. A lender's processing estimate also cannot by itself amend the parties' terms.

05 Conversation answers

Offers, Counteroffers, Negotiation, and Contingencies

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. closing date. Turn 2. The proposed closing date is earlier than the lender's provisional processing range and is not yet an agreed or assured date.

2. financing contingency. Turn 4. The financing contingency has specific contractual conditions and actions; it cannot turn an unconfirmed timeline into guaranteed financing.

3. waiver. Turn 6. A waiver gives up a right or condition; discussing competitiveness does not authorize the agent to remove protections.

4. earnest money. Turn 8. Earnest money is governed by the agreement and applicable requirements; the label does not guarantee automatic return.

5. contingency deadline. Turn 10. A contingency deadline governs timely exercise or satisfaction of a condition; its consequences depend on the actual contract.

6. extension request. Turn 12. An extension request proposes a new deadline; it does not change the existing agreement without the required acceptance.

7. counteroffer. Turn 14. A counteroffer proposes different terms and requires review; it should not be reported as acceptance of the unchanged original offer.

8. deposit holder. Turn 16. The deposit holder is the person or entity authorized to hold the funds; the case has not yet established that arrangement.

9. possession date. Turn 18. Possession is governed by the agreement and need not be identical to closing or to an unaccepted proposed date.

10. authorized instruction. Turn 20. An authorized instruction identifies the buyer's actual decision; it is distinct from this preliminary exploration of options.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. Monday

Agent: "The proposed new deadline is Monday."

Monday is the requested date, not an already accepted contractual change.

2. Friday

Buyer: "The existing stated deadline remains Friday at 5 p.m."

No accepted change is supplied, so the original stated deadline must not be treated as replaced.

3. agreement

Agent: "We need confirmation of the required agreement."

The request alone does not establish that the other party has accepted the alteration.

4. approved

Buyer: "Do not describe the extension as approved."

The case supplies no approval, so that label would invent a completed decision.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Inspections, Repairs, Disclosures, and Due Diligence

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What does the report establish in this case?

B. Staining was observed and specialist evaluation was recommended

The report states an observation and recommendation, not a cause, repair specification, or contractual agreement.

2. How does the seller's disclosure describe prior water intrusion?

A. Unknown

Unknown records an unresolved fact; it is not proof of absence, repair, or an agreed concession.

3. Which next step is supported?

A. Arrange qualified evaluation and review the contractual response requirements

The case needs technical evaluation and contract review before a diagnosis, cost, or obligation can be asserted.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which handover to the specialist preserves exactly what the report establishes?

D. Basement staining observed; cause and repair scope not established.

The report documents staining and recommends further evaluation. It supplies no cause, repair history, active plumbing diagnosis, or warranty finding.

2. How should the unknown disclosure response be interpreted?

B. The relevant history is not established by that answer.

Unknown does not establish either absence, completed repair, compliance, or a contractual concession.

3. Which statement about seller payment is appropriate?

A. We need the actual contract and any negotiated agreement before asserting an obligation.

The case supplies no agreement or established obligation, so the contractual question requires review.

4. Which update correctly distinguishes progress?

A. The referral is underway; the appointment and repair scope remain unconfirmed.

The update reports only the actual referral step and leaves unfinished arrangements and terms open.

06 Conversation answers

Inspections, Repairs, Disclosures, and Due Diligence

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. visual observation.** Turn 2. The observation identifies visible staining; it does not establish the underlying cause or the work needed to address it.
- 2. inspection scope.** Turn 4. Inspection scope identifies what the inspection covers and its limits; a general report need not resolve every specialist question.
- 3. seller disclosure.** Turn 6. The seller disclosure records an unknown history here, not a verified statement that water intrusion never occurred.
- 4. specialist referral.** Turn 8. A specialist referral connects the buyer with appropriate expertise; it does not itself establish a diagnosis or confirmed appointment.
- 5. root cause.** Turn 10. The root cause is the underlying source of the problem, which the present inspection has not identified.
- 6. repair scope.** Turn 12. Repair scope defines the actual work being priced; without it, a cost figure may refer to a different or incomplete service.
- 7. repair request.** Turn 14. A repair request proposes work for negotiation; the seller has not yet accepted any repair obligation in the case.
- 8. due diligence.** Turn 16. Due diligence includes the investigation and contractual review; continuing an evaluation does not itself alter a contractual deadline.
- 9. reinspection.** Turn 18. A reinspection can assess specified completed work or conditions; it is distinct from merely receiving a contractor's promise.
- 10. repair credit.** Turn 20. A repair credit is a negotiated allowance; the current report does not establish its amount or the seller's acceptance.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. assessment

Buyer: "The \$250 is for the assessment."

The supplied quotation prices an evaluation visit rather than repair work.

2. repairs

Agent: "It excludes repairs."

The quotation expressly excludes repairs, so they must not be described as included.

3. confirmation

Buyer: "The appointment still needs confirmation."

The visit has not been booked, so the quotation is not evidence of a confirmed appointment.

4. scope

Agent: "A repair price will need a defined scope."

A meaningful repair price requires specified work, which has not yet been supplied.

06

07 Briefing and language checks

Financing, Appraisal, Title, Escrow, and Closing

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What does the checklist confirm?

D. The appraisal has been received

The checklist records receipt of the appraisal only; the other milestones remain unresolved.

2. Who owns the investigation into the recorded prior lien?

B. The title professional

The title professional investigates the recorded claim. The appraiser addresses value, the coordinator tracks updates, and the underwriter assesses the loan; those roles do not replace this assigned title investigation.

3. What is the status of the \$25,000 figure?

C. A draft cash-to-close calculation

The amount is explicitly a draft settlement calculation, not a confirmed instruction or other transaction value.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which closing update is accurate?

D. The appraisal is received, while title and final lender approval remain open.

The statement reports the completed receipt milestone and preserves the two separate unresolved approval issues.

2. Who should explain the unresolved lien record?

B. The title professional handling the investigation

The briefing assigns the record investigation to the title professional; the coordinator should relay verified information.

3. Which statement properly limits the \$25,000 amount?

B. It is a draft calculation; final figures and payment instructions need verification.

The draft status prevents treating the figure as final or drawing unsupported conclusions about other amounts.

4. Which question distinguishes escrow uses?

D. Are we discussing transaction funds held pending conditions or the mortgage account for ongoing costs?

Escrow can name different arrangements, so the context must be identified before explaining its function.

07 Conversation answers

Financing, Appraisal, Title, Escrow, and Closing

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. appraisal.** Turn 2. The appraisal is a value-related document; receiving it does not establish that all title and lending conditions are complete.
- 2. lien.** Turn 4. The recorded lien is the identified title matter; its presence requires review rather than an unsupported assumption that it is cleared.
- 3. lien release.** Turn 6. A lien release addresses the recorded claim; an assumption about past payment is not confirmation that the required release is established.
- 4. underwriting.** Turn 8. Underwriting is the lender's assessment process; submitted documents do not themselves prove that its conditions are satisfied.
- 5. clear to close.** Turn 10. Clear to close is a lender status within its process; it should not be used as a universal substitute for every transaction confirmation.
- 6. cash to close.** Turn 12. Cash to close is the amount due under a settlement calculation; a draft amount is not yet a verified instruction to pay.
- 7. settlement statement.** Turn 14. The settlement statement itemizes funds and charges, helping distinguish cash due from one component such as the down payment.
- 8. escrow.** Turn 16. Escrow can refer to transaction holding or a mortgage account for certain ongoing costs; the surrounding document determines the meaning.
- 9. disbursement.** Turn 18. Disbursement is the release of funds, a distinct status that should be confirmed rather than inferred from signatures alone.
- 10. recording.** Turn 20. Recording is entry into the public records, with status and timing requiring the appropriate professional's confirmation.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. unverified

Buyer: "The account change is currently unverified."

The unexpected message has not been confirmed through the established closing contact.

2. transfer

Coordinator: "Pause the transfer while it is checked."

No payment should be treated as ready solely on the basis of the unconfirmed account change.

3. number

Buyer: "I will use the previously verified contact number."

The supplied trusted number avoids relying on new contact details inside the suspicious message.

4. professional

Coordinator: "Obtain confirmation from the responsible closing professional."

The closing professional is the appropriate source for verifying the instruction, not the unconfirmed email alone.

08 Briefing and language checks

Leasing, Property Management, Commercial Basics, Ethics, and Crisis Scenarios

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What has actually been completed?

D. Both reports have been logged

The briefing confirms logging only; appointment, repair, and financial remedy remain unconfirmed.

2. What can Asha commit to by 2 p.m.?

C. A status update

The authorized commitment is communication of status, not those unresolved operational or financial outcomes.

3. What needs checking now?

B. Current conditions and the appropriate response urgency

The case says current conditions need checking, which informs urgency without authorizing diagnosis or bypassing entry rules.

08

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which response combines empathy with accurate ownership?

C. You reported this twice without an update; I own the follow-up and will update you by 2 p.m.

The response acknowledges the specific failure and makes the authorized communication commitment without inventing an outcome.

2. Which status pair accurately describes the maintenance case?

D. Reports logged; contractor attendance unconfirmed

Logging and follow-up ownership are confirmed, but the contractor has not replied. That is not acceptance of a visit, repair authorization, or an access agreement.

3. What should happen before treating the request as completed?

B. Verify the actual work and record the resulting status.

Completion requires evidence of the relevant work, not merely a communication or an absence of further messages.

4. Which statement keeps the rent question within scope?

D. The requested adjustment needs the applicable review and is not approved yet.

The supplied facts establish no authorized adjustment, and actual rights require the relevant lease and law.

08 Conversation answers

Leasing, Property Management, Commercial Basics, Ethics, and Crisis Scenarios

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. service requests. Turn 2. Service requests record the tenant's reports; their existence does not mean attendance or repair has been arranged.

2. active leak. Turn 4. An active leak describes the current continuing condition; it affects urgency without establishing the technical cause.

3. attendance window. Turn 6. An attendance window is a confirmed expected arrival period; none has been supplied by the contractor yet.

4. work order. Turn 8. The work order should preserve the linked reports, current condition, and responsible owner rather than treat the second report as unrelated.

5. service recovery. Turn 10. Service recovery addresses the missed communication with an owned next step; it does not create a guaranteed repair result.

6. access arrangement. Turn 12. Access arrangements must follow the applicable requirements and practical agreement; the report does not authorize unrestricted entry.

7. repair authorization. Turn 14. Repair authorization defines approval for specified work; contacting a contractor does not automatically approve every possible additional task.

8. completion record. Turn 16. A completion record supports the actual work status; a phone call or reference number alone is not proof of repair.

9. rent adjustment. Turn 18. A rent adjustment requires the applicable authority, agreement, or legal basis; no approval exists in this case.

10. triage. Turn 20. Triage assesses urgency and response as conditions develop; it should continue alongside scheduling and communication.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. rent

Tenant: "The \$2,000 is the monthly base rent."

The proposal identifies that amount as base rent, not the entire occupancy cost.

2. charge

Agent: "Common-area maintenance is an additional charge."

The proposal adds a defined share of maintenance rather than including it in the base amount.

3. details

Tenant: "We still need the allocation details."

The method for determining the tenant's share is explicitly missing from the supplied information.

4. total

Agent: "Do not present \$2,000 as the complete monthly total."

An additional, unquantified charge prevents the base rent from being described as the full monthly amount.

08

09 Conversation answers

Two office rents use different area figures

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. rentable area. Turn 2. Rentable area is the quoted charging basis, which here is 1,200 square feet rather than the 1,000 usable figure.

2. usable area. Turn 4. Usable area describes the space available for the occupant's use under the stated measurement basis, distinct from the quoted rentable area.

3. base rent. Turn 6. Base rent is the stated rental charge before any additional amounts that the lease may require.

4. operating expenses. Turn 10. Operating expenses are building-running costs whose allocation and recovery depend on the proposed lease terms.

5. tenant improvement allowance. Turn 12. A tenant improvement allowance is a proposed landlord contribution toward eligible fit-out work, subject to its terms.

6. rent commencement. Turn 16. Rent commencement is the date rent begins under the agreement, which may differ from access or lease commencement.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. year

Tenant: Twenty-four times nine hundred gives \$21,600 per year.

The rate is annual, so multiplying by the area produces annual base rent.

2. rent

Broker: Dividing by twelve gives \$1,800 in monthly base rent.

The calculation converts the annual base rental amount into its monthly equivalent.

3. charges

Tenant: That still excludes any additional charges.

The quotation does not supply the other amounts that may be payable.

4. cost

Broker: Correct. We cannot describe \$1,800 as the total occupancy cost.

Total occupancy cost cannot be established while additional charges remain unknown.

10 Conversation answers

Low monthly dues and an unfinished roof review

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. association budget. Turn 2. The association budget shows planned income and spending; the dues figure alone does not show what is funded.

2. reserves. Turn 6. Reserves are funds set aside for future needs such as major repairs, distinct from simply quoting the monthly dues.

3. special assessment. Turn 10. A special assessment is an additional association charge for a specified need; none has been confirmed in this case.

4. delinquency. Turn 14. Delinquency refers to overdue payments; the association's report can show whether that is a material issue.

5. master policy. Turn 16. The master policy is the association's insurance arrangement; its coverage must not be assumed to replace every owner's insurance need.

6. document-review deadline. Turn 18. The document-review deadline is the relevant contractual or legal time limit; requesting documents does not automatically extend it.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. assessment

Buyer: The elevator estimate is not yet an approved assessment.

An estimate for work does not establish an additional charge approved for owners.

2. decision

Representative: Correct. We need the association's actual funding decision.

The missing funding decision determines how the proposed project would be financed.

3. dues

Buyer: Keep the preliminary figure separate from confirmed recurring dues.

Dues are the recurring association charge, not the preliminary project estimate.

4. update

Representative: I will also check the date of the next document update.

An update is needed because the preliminary project and funding information may change.

10

11 Conversation answers

The final walkthrough reveals a missing appliance

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. discrepancy. Turn 2. Discrepancy identifies the difference between the agreement and the property's observed condition.

2. final walkthrough. Turn 6. The final walkthrough checks the property's condition and relevant agreed items near closing; it is not automatically a new full technical inspection.

3. possession condition. Turn 8. Possession condition refers to the state in which the agreement requires the property to be handed over.

4. closing credit. Turn 14. A closing credit is an agreed adjustment in the settlement figures, subject to required documentation and applicable constraints.

5. written amendment. Turn 16. A written amendment records an agreed contractual change; a verbal promise does not by itself supply those documented terms.

6. punch list. Turn 20. A punch list records specific outstanding items for follow-up; listing an item does not establish that it has been resolved.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. item

Buyer: Record the furniture as an outstanding walkthrough item.

The furniture is a specific unresolved condition found during the walkthrough.

2. amendment

Representative: The verbal promise does not establish an agreed amendment.

The buyer has not agreed to change the existing contractual arrangement.

3. require

Buyer: Ask the closing professionals what documentation the proposed change would require.

The professionals must review the needed documentation and effects of any proposed change.

4. acceptance

Representative: I will report the response without treating it as your acceptance.

The buyer has not accepted the proposal, so coordination must not imply consent.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Agency, Representation, Compensation, and Trust

Address the question: We should clarify whom the brokerage represents before discussing your strategy.

Use the documents: Let us review the applicable agreement and disclosures.

Close with verification: I will obtain the role information and broker guidance first.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Client Intake, Needs Analysis, and Property Search

Clarify the adjective: What specific features would make the area work well for you?

Separate priorities: Which requirements are essential, and which are preferences?

Close with a shortlist: I will compare properties against your stated criteria.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Listings, Property Descriptions, Pricing, and Market Data

Validate the arithmetic: The simple average is \$480,000.

Name the condition difference: Sale C required major repairs.

Close with analysis: Let us verify the comparison before setting the pricing recommendation.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Showings, Open Houses, Fair Housing, and Advertising

Identify the concern: This line expresses a household preference rather than a property feature.

Apply consistency: Give every visitor the same relevant property information.

Close with ownership: I will send the request to the responsible colleague and track the response.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Offers, Counteroffers, Negotiation, and Contingencies

Name the mismatch: The proposed 30-day close is earlier than the lender's provisional range.

Preserve authority: I will not remove a protection without your informed instruction and proper review.

Close with review: Confirm the timing and terms before authorizing the offer.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Inspections, Repairs, Disclosures, and Due Diligence

Attribute the finding: The report records staining and recommends specialist evaluation.

Explain unknown: The seller marked that history as unknown, not confirmed absent.

Close with tracking: We will track the evaluation and contractual response requirements.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Financing, Appraisal, Title, Escrow, and Closing

Acknowledge progress: The appraisal has been received.

Separate approvals: Appraisal receipt does not confirm final lender approval.

Close with owners: I will obtain the title and lender updates separately.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Leasing, Property Management, Commercial Basics, Ethics, and Crisis Scenarios

Acknowledge the failure: You reported this twice and did not receive an update.

Assess urgency: Please report any immediate danger through the appropriate emergency route.

Close with the record: I will record the current facts, owner, and next contact.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

absorption rate define the absorption-rate basis	23
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access arrangement confirm the access arrangement	69
access request respond to an access request	32
accessible component identify accessible components	50
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adjustment explain a valuation adjustment	23
advertising copy review advertising copy	33
agency clarify the agency relationship	5
agreement term confirm the agreement term	6
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Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

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commission explain the commission basis	6
common-area maintenance reconcile common-area maintenance charges	69
comparable sale select comparable sales	23
comparative market analysis prepare a comparative market analysis	23
compensation negotiate compensation	6
complaint route explain the complaint route	33
completion record verify the completion record	69
concession verify seller concessions	23
condition compare property condition	23
conditional approval review conditional approval	59
confidential information handle confidential information	6
conflict of interest disclose a conflict of interest	6
contingency review the contingency	41
contingency deadline track the contingency deadline	41
contractor quotation review the contractor quotation	51
counteroffer review a counteroffer	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

days on market compare days on market	23
debt-to-income ratio explain the debt-to-income basis	59
default obtain advice about default	42
deferred maintenance identify deferred maintenance	24
deficiency describe the reported deficiency	50
deposit holder identify the deposit holder	41
designated agency explain designated agency	5
disbursement confirm authorized disbursement	60
disclosure packet provide the disclosure packet	33
disclosure supplement request a disclosure supplement	51
discriminatory preference remove a discriminatory preference	32
door-to-door journey estimate the door-to-door journey	14
dual agency review dual-agency restrictions	5
due diligence track due-diligence items	51
earnest money explain earnest-money terms	41
easement review the recorded easement	60
emergency response use the emergency-response process	68
encumbrance identify an encumbrance	60
entry notice check entry-notice requirements	69
equal service provide equal service	32
escrow clarify which escrow is meant	60
exclusivity clarify the exclusivity term	6
extension request submit an extension request	42
fair housing follow fair-housing requirements	32

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

familial status recognize familial-status concerns	32
fee obligation identify the fee obligation	6
fenced patio verify the fenced patio	33
fiduciary duty explain applicable fiduciary duties	5
financing contingency explain the financing contingency	41
floor plan review the floor plan	15
further evaluation recommend further evaluation	50
home inspection arrange a home inspection	50
home-sale contingency review the home-sale contingency	41
informed consent obtain required informed consent	6
inspection contingency review the inspection contingency	41
inspection limitation document an inspection limitation	50
inspection scope review the inspection scope	50
insurance premium obtain an insurance-premium estimate	15
lease review the lease terms	68
lender's title insurance distinguish lender's title insurance	60
lessee identify the lessee	68
lessor identify the lessor	68
lien investigate a recorded lien	59
lien release verify the lien release	59
list price set the list price	23
listing agreement examine the listing agreement	6
listing status confirm the listing status	24
living area verify the living-area basis	24

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

loan commitment review the loan commitment	59
loan-to-value ratio confirm the loan-to-value basis	59
lot size confirm the lot size	24
managing broker consult the managing broker	5
market exposure assess market exposure	24
material fact disclose a material fact	6
measurement source identify the measurement source	24
moisture intrusion investigate moisture intrusion	50
months of supply calculate months of supply	23
must-have identify the must-haves	14
needs analysis conduct a needs analysis	14
negotiating position clarify the negotiating position	42
non-agency relationship clarify a non-agency relationship	5
notice requirement check the notice requirement	42
objective feature describe objective features	32
occupancy standard verify an occupancy standard	32
offer expiration verify the offer expiration	41
open house host an open house	33
owner's title insurance review owner's title-insurance coverage	60
ownership costs estimate ownership costs	15
peak-hour travel check peak-hour travel	14
pending sale distinguish pending sales from closed sales	24
permit verify permit requirements	51
permitted use confirm the permitted use	69

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

photograph caption	check the photograph caption	33
possession date	confirm the possession date	42
preapproval	review preapproval conditions	15
preference	rank property preferences	14
prequalification	clarify the prequalification basis	15
price per square foot	compare price per square foot	24
price reduction	document a price reduction	23
pricing range	support the pricing range	24
principal	identify the principal	5
property amenity	describe property amenities	33
property tax	check the property-tax estimate	15
protected characteristic	avoid decisions based on protected characteristics	32
purchase budget	clarify the purchase budget	15
purchase offer	prepare a purchase offer	41
rate lock	verify the rate-lock terms	59
reasonable accommodation	route a reasonable-accommodation request	32
reasonable modification	distinguish a reasonable modification	32
recording	confirm recording status	60
reinspection	arrange a reinspection	51
remedy	clarify available remedies	42
renewal option	review the renewal option	69
renovation	verify the renovation scope	24
rent adjustment	review a requested rent adjustment	69
rent roll	update the rent roll	68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

repair agreement confirm the repair agreement	51
repair authorization obtain repair authorization	69
repair credit review the proposed repair credit	51
repair estimate obtain a repair estimate	51
repair request submit a repair request	51
repair scope define the repair scope	50
representation agreement review the representation agreement	5
root cause establish the root cause	50
sale price verify the sale price	23
search criterion refine the search criteria	14
search radius define the search radius	14
security deposit account for the security deposit	68
seller credit request a seller credit	42
seller disclosure review the seller disclosure	51
seller representation confirm seller representation	5
service recovery coordinate service recovery	69
service request acknowledge the service request	68
service scope define the service scope	6
settlement statement reconcile the settlement statement	60
shortlist build a property shortlist	15
showing appointment confirm a showing appointment	32
showing feedback record property-focused showing feedback	33
special assessment ask about special assessments	15
specialist referral coordinate a specialist referral	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

staining document wall staining	50
steering avoid discriminatory steering	32
step-free access verify step-free access	14
subject property describe the subject property	23
tenant improvement define tenant-improvement responsibilities	69
termination provision review the termination provision	6
title commitment review the title commitment	60
title exception explain a title exception	60
title search complete the title search	59
trade-off explain a trade-off	14
transaction broker verify the transaction-broker role	5
transport interchange check the transport interchange	14
triage triage the maintenance report	68
underwriting track underwriting conditions	59
utility cost compare utility costs	15
valuation date state the valuation date	24
vendor follow up with the vendor	69
virtual tour offer the approved virtual tour	33
visitor register maintain the visitor register	33
visual observation record a visual observation	50
waiver explain the proposed waiver	42
walkability assess walkability using specific routes	14
warranty review warranty exclusions	51
work order open a work order	68

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] National Association of REALTORS. Consumer Guide: Agency and Non-Agency Relationships.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on representation terminology and state-law variation. No particular relationship or fee arrangement is presumed for the fictional cases. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] US Department of Housing and Urban Development. Housing Discrimination Under the Fair Housing Act.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on US federal fair-housing protections. Practical language examples focus on objective property facts and consistent service; local requirements need separate verification. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] Consumer Financial Protection Bureau. Closing on your new home.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on documents, professionals, and stages in a US mortgage closing. The teaching cases do not prescribe universal deadlines or approve a transaction. Checked 10 October 2026.

[4] American Society of Home Inspectors. Standard of Practice.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on inspection scope and recommendations for further evaluation. Actual scope depends on the applicable standard, agreement, and professional qualifications. Checked 10 October 2026.

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